

Project management file

Project management file: initiation and project start

Project	
Kind of project	
Organisation	
Project status	
PM plan version	
Prepared by	
Last updated	

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Project at a glance

Your project file for the initiation and start of a project, from the first idea to the approved PM plan. Fill it in section by section; the graphics update as you type.

Method: How to use this workbook

1. Start with the project details below. Name, dates and status feed the graphics on every page.
2. Work through the sections in the menu in order. Section 1 shows the ten steps and where each one is documented.
3. Grey text in a field or table is a hint from the template. Replace it with your own words.
4. Switch on Example at the top to see a filled-in sample project. It is read-only, and your own file stays as it is.
5. Your entries are saved as you type.
6. Export makes a Word file with every table and graphic, and an Excel file with every table.

Project

Project name	
Kind of project	
Project status	
Organisation	
Prepared by	
PM plan version	
Last updated	
Currency	€
Short description	

Start and end

Start event	
Start date	
End event	
End date	
Duration	

Project at a glance

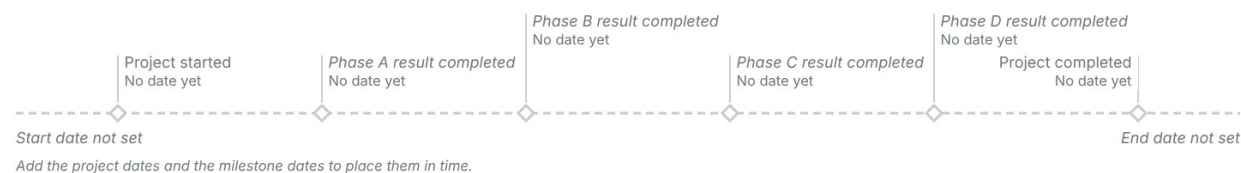
Project name

Kind of project · organisation

Status not set

Timeline and milestones

◇ Baseline date ◆ Actual date — Project duration



The ten steps

0 of 10 done

Initiation process



Project start process



Key figures

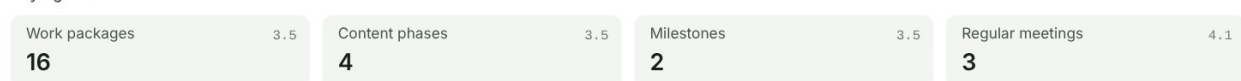


Figure 1: Project, timeline with the milestones, the status of the ten steps and the key figures of the plans. Hollow diamonds are baseline dates, filled ones actual dates.

Key figures

Figure	Value	From section
Project duration		At a glance
Steps done		1 Process map
Business case (net)		3.1 Assess the idea
Category		3.2 Categorise the project
Objectives		3.3 Six fields
Rough budget		3.3 Six fields
Stakeholders		3.4 Stakeholders
Critical stakeholders		3.4 Stakeholders
Work packages	16	3.5 Scope and WBS
Content phases	4	3.5 Scope and WBS
Milestones	2	3.5 Schedule
Planned cost		3.5 Resources and costs
Person-days		3.5 Resources and costs
Team size		4.1 Project organisation
Regular meetings	3	4.1 Communication and culture
Work packages with one R		4.2 RACI chart
WP specifications agreed		4.2 Work package specifications
Critical path		4.2 Linked bar chart and network
Plans validated		4.3 Consolidate and coordinate
PM plan version		4.4 Finalise the PM plan
Project start process		4.5 Approve the PM plan
Risk budget		5 Risk management
High risks		5 Risk management
Communication formats used		6 Kick-off and start workshop
Accepted change requests		7 Contract management
Critical situation answers		8 Tailoring

Figure	Value	From section
Methods used		8 Tailoring

Glossary

Term	Meaning	What we call it in our organisation
PO, PS	Project owner or project sponsor: two names for the same role. Strategic responsibility; represents the company in the project.	
PM	Project manager. Full operative responsibility; a project has exactly one.	
PMTM, PTM	Project management team member: a core team member who is responsible for work packages.	
PSC	Steering committee above the project.	
PMO	Project management office.	
Project Charter	The project assignment, signed by PO and PM.	
PM plan, PHB	All project plans and documents in one place, also called the project handbook.	
WBS	Work breakdown structure: every task of the project, ordered by phase.	
WP	Work package: a task in the WBS with one responsible person.	
WBS code	Code of a WBS line, also called code of account (CoA), for example 1.3.3.	
PD	Person-days (also written MD or PT).	
BC	Business case: costs against benefits over the life cycle.	
CR	Change request: a formal request to change scope, dates or costs.	

1 Process map: the ten steps

Two processes of five steps each take a project from the first idea to an approved PM plan. Record for each step what happened in your project.

Method: What goes in and what comes out

- Initiation process (steps I1 to I5): starts with a project idea and ends with the (preliminarily) released Project Charter.
- Project start process (steps S1 to S5): starts with the preliminary charter and ends with the final charter and the approved PM plan, version 1.0.
- Each process ends with a decision of the PO: project approval in I5 and approval of the PM plan in S5.
- The ten steps are an example. Section 8 shows how to scale them to your project.

Process map

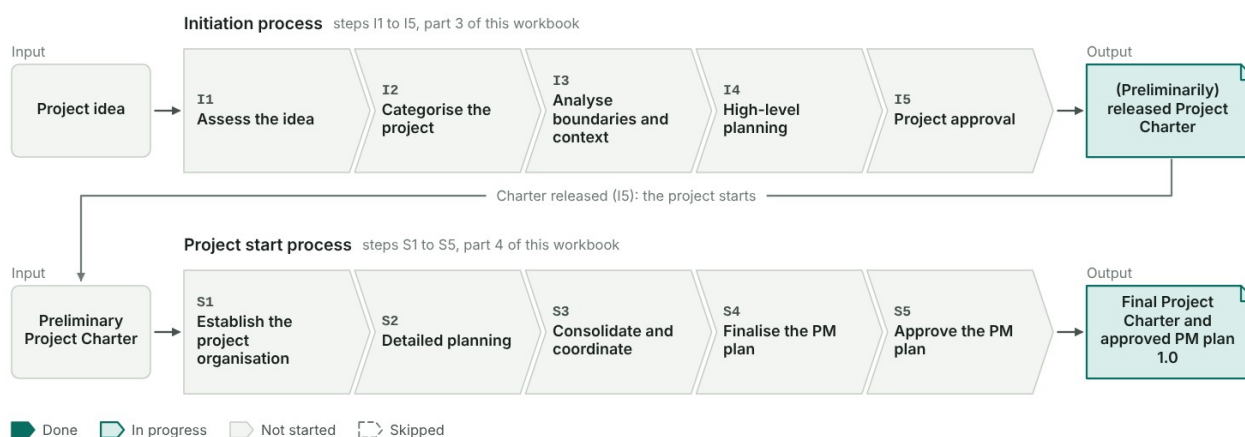


Figure 2: Each chevron is one step, coloured by its status in the table below, with the date you entered. The released charter at the end of the initiation is the input of the project start.

The ten steps in your project

Step	Step	Status	When	Format used	Who took part	What we did	Result
I1	Assess the idea						
I2	Categorise the project						
I3	Analyse boundaries and context						
I4	High-level planning						
I5	Project approval						
S1	Establish the project organisation						
S2	Detailed planning						
S3	Consolidate and coordinate						
S4	Finalise the PM plan						
S5	Approve the PM plan						

Initiation process: activities, roles, formats, results

	I1 Assess the idea	I2 Categorise the project	I3 Analyse boundaries and context	I4 High-level planning	I5 Project approval
Activities	- Describe the rough idea - Check strategy fit - Check technical feasibility - Create a business case	- Check whether it is worth a project - Categorise its complexity - Appoint PO and PM	- Prepare the six fields (possibly in variants) - Run the stakeholder analysis - Make a first risk assessment	- Verify the six fields and the stakeholder analysis - Make a first plan of scope, dates, resources and costs	- Draft the charter and agree the PM plan with the PO - Verify the business case
Roles	- Accounting - Sales - Department - Controlling	- PO - PMO - PSC	- PO and PM - Possibly designated PMTMs	- PM - Designated PMTMs - Experts	- PO - PM
Format	- Individual planning - One-to-one talks	- Individual planning - One-to-one talks	- One-to-one talks - Initial PO meeting	Planning workshop	- PO meeting - Face to face
Result	Decision to implement	Project category, first project roles	First draft of the charter, proposal for the planning process	Initial Project Charter, first draft of the PM plan	(Preliminarily) released Project Charter

Event format: meeting or workshop
 Grey italic: the method's default until you describe the step
 Done
 In progress
 Not started
 Skipped

Figure 3: One column per step. Each cell shows what you wrote in the table above; until then it shows the method's default in grey italics. Amber marks the formats that are events, the meetings and workshops.

Project start process: activities, roles, formats, results

	S1 Establish the project organisation	S2 Detailed planning	S3 Consolidate and coordinate	S4 Finalise the PM plan	S5 Approve the PM plan
Activities	- Present and validate the results so far - Clarify roles, communication and ground rules	- Write WP specifications - Assess detailed dates, resources and costs	- Complete bar chart, staff deployment, cost plan and risk analysis - Set up project marketing	- Consolidate all plans in the PM plan and send it to all PMTMs - Hold a last internal meeting on open points	- Present the planning to PO or PSC - Agree roles and communication structures
Roles	- PM - PMTMs - Team members - Possibly PO	- PM - PMTMs	- PM - PMTMs	- PM - Project assistant - PMTMs	- PO or PSC - PM
Format	- Kick-off - Start workshop	- Individual planning - One-to-one talks - Start workshop	- Individual planning - One-to-one talks - Follow-up workshop	- E-mail - One-to-one talks	- PO meeting - PSC meeting
Result	Working project organisation, common big picture	Detailed work packages	Validated and amended plans	Draft PM plan, version 1.0	Approved PM plan, version 1.0

Event format: meeting or workshop
 Grey italic: the method's default until you describe the step
 Done
 In progress
 Not started
 Skipped

Figure 4: One column per step. Each cell shows what you wrote in the table above; until then it shows the method's default in grey italics. Amber marks the formats that are events, the meetings and workshops.

2 Core ideas and planning depth

The ideas behind the method and how deep your planning goes. Note how each one applies to your project.

Three views of a project

A project is a task, a temporary organisation and a social system at the same time. Each view asks something different of the planning.

Task with special characteristics	
Temporary organisation	
Social system	

Four principles of the approach

The method rests on four principles. Describe how you applied each one.

Principles in practice

	Principle	In practice	How we applied it
M	Management process	Project management applies methods, tools, techniques and competencies to the project.	
I	Iterative, process-oriented	Work in cycles of observing, deciding and acting. Plans are adapted step by step.	
S	Systemic-constructivist	There is more than one reality, so the team has to build a common view.	
T	Team-oriented	Project management is shared work: the whole team plans and controls.	

The project management process

Every stage ends with a document. This workbook covers the first two stages.

Project management process

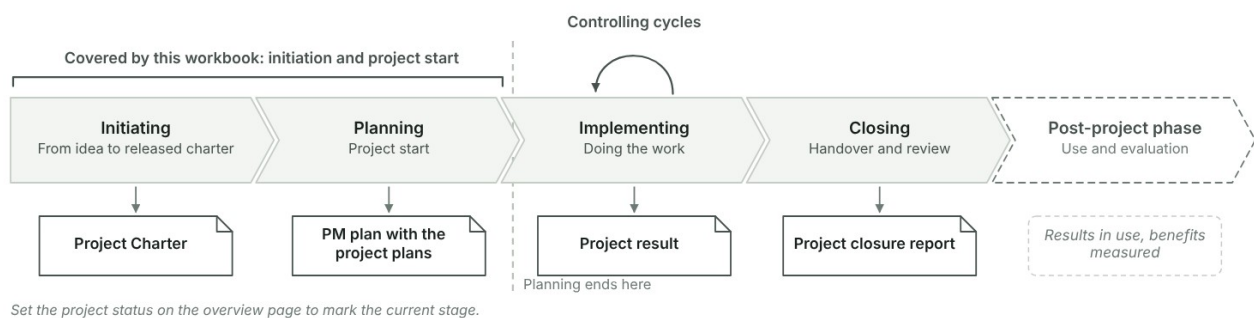


Figure 5: Initiating and planning are covered here; controlling runs in cycles during the implementation. The stage that matches the project status on the overview page is highlighted.

Planning effort

The more complex the task, the more planning it needs. Processes and line tasks stay in the line; projects and programmes get a temporary organisation.

Planning effort ladder

Categorise the project in section 3.2 to mark where it sits.

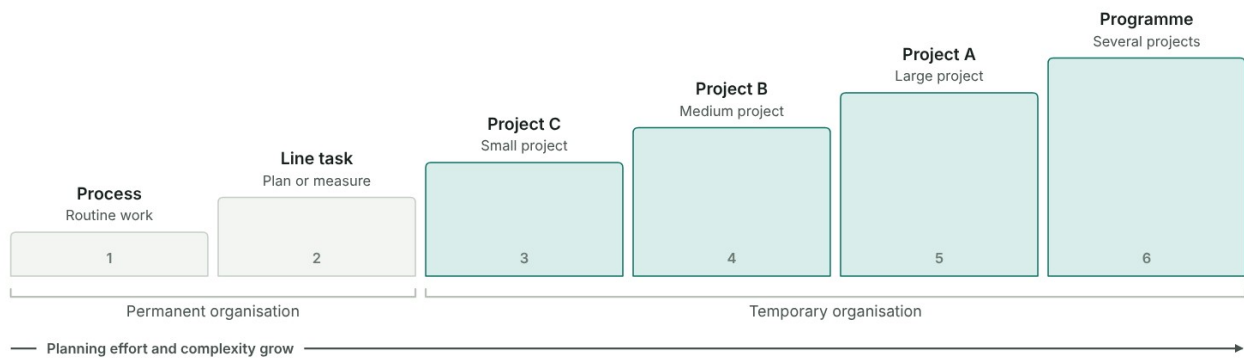


Figure 6: From routine process to programme, each step needs more planning. The marker shows the category set in section 3.2 (project class C, B or A).

The marker comes from the categorisation in section 3.2.

Triple constraint and planning depth

Scope, time, and resources and costs each get a plan. How deep each plan goes depends on the project, but no corner may be skipped.

How deep we plan

Scope plan	
Schedule	
Resource and cost plan	

Triple constraint

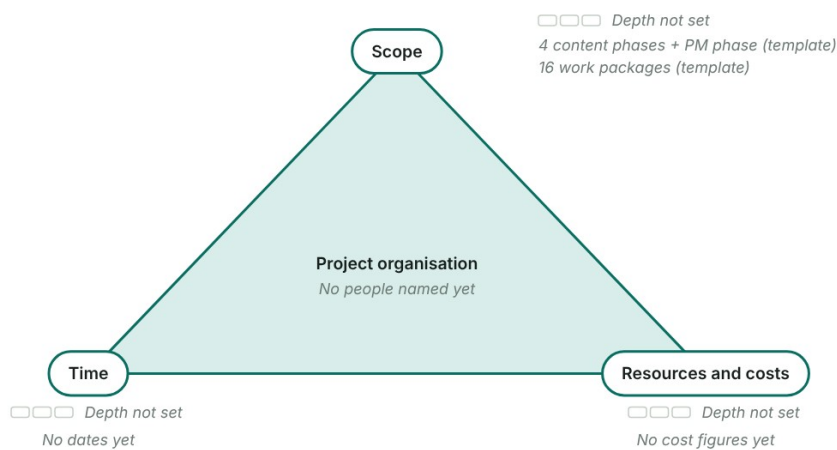


Figure 7: The project organisation sits in the middle and holds the three plans together. Each corner shows the chosen planning depth and this project's figures.

Method pyramid

The more complex the project, the further up the pyramid the planning goes. Risk management grows with it.

Method pyramid

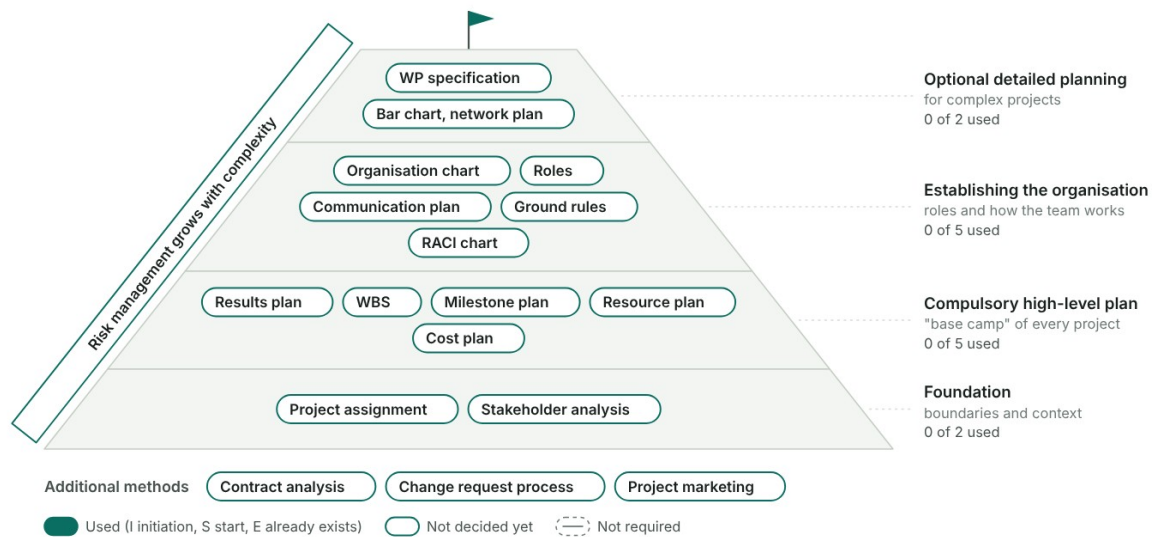


Figure 8: Methods by level, from the foundation to optional detailed planning, styled by the decisions in the method check.

Decide in the method check of section 8 which methods this project uses.

3.1 Assess the idea

Before anyone plans, check whether the idea fits the strategy, can be done and pays off. The result is a recorded decision.

Method: How to assess an idea

1. Describe the idea in a few sentences: what it is, who proposed it and why now.
2. Strategy fit: check that it serves the company strategy and makes the project portfolio better as a whole.
3. Technical feasibility: check that the objectives are manageable, decide whether it is a concept or an implementation project, and whether a feasibility study must come first.
4. Economic viability: set costs against benefits over the whole life cycle, name the uncertainties and compare the alternatives, including doing nothing.
5. Close with a recorded decision: implement, reject, postpone or study feasibility first.

Step record I1: Assess the idea

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

The idea

Rough idea	
Proposed by	
Proposed on	
Type of project	
Feasibility study	

Three checks

Check	Question	Answer	Assessment
A. Strategy fit	Does the project close a gap between our objectives and the company strategy?		
A. Strategy fit	Does it make our project portfolio better as a whole?		
B. Technical feasibility	Are the objectives manageable with our skills, tools and capacity?		
B. Technical feasibility	Is it clear whether this is a concept project or an implementation project?		
B. Technical feasibility	Can we plan it without a feasibility study first?		
C. Economic viability	Do the benefits outweigh the costs over the whole life cycle (business case)?		
C. Economic viability	Are the uncertainties in costs and benefits known and acceptable?		
C. Economic viability	Is this the best of the alternatives we compared, including doing nothing?		

Business case

Costs and benefits over the whole life cycle, by year or period

Costs and benefits

No.	Item	Type	Nature	Year or period	Amount (€)	Note
1		Cost	One-off			
2		Cost	One-off			
3		Cost	Recurring			
4		Benefit	Recurring			
5		Benefit	One-off			
	Total				Cost € 0 / Benefit € 0	

Result

Total cost	
Total benefit	
Net benefit	
Benefit / cost ratio	

Alternatives compared

No.	Alternative	Description	Cost (€)	Benefit	Risk	Decision
1						
2						
3						

Decision

Decision	
Decided by	
Decided on	
Conditions and next steps	

Idea assessment

A. Strategy fit Not assessed yet	B. Technical feasibility Not assessed yet	C. Economic viability Not assessed yet	Decision Not decided yet
Closes a strategy gap Open <i>No answer yet</i>	Objectives manageable Open <i>No answer yet</i>	Business case positive Open <i>No answer yet</i>	Decision open Conditions <i>None recorded</i> Business case <i>No amounts yet</i>
Improves the portfolio Open <i>No answer yet</i>	Project type clear Open <i>No answer yet</i>	Uncertainty acceptable Open <i>No answer yet</i>	
No study needed Open <i>No answer yet</i>	Best alternative Open <i>No answer yet</i>		

Figure 9: Each card is one question of the three checks, coloured by its assessment. The last column shows the decision they led to.

3.2 Categorise the project

Decide whether the idea is worth a project and how big it is. Then appoint the project owner and the project manager.

Method: How to categorise

1. Check whether the task is worth a project at all. Small tasks run better in the line organisation.
2. Compare the project with your company's thresholds for divisions involved, duration, internal effort and external spend.
3. Take the category most criteria reach, then confirm it or overrule it with a reason.
4. Give it a size class if your company uses them: C small, B medium, A large.
5. Appoint the project owner and the project manager, and name the first core team members if you can.

Step record I2: Categorise the project

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

Every company sets its own limits. The grey numbers are one company's example; type your own values over them.

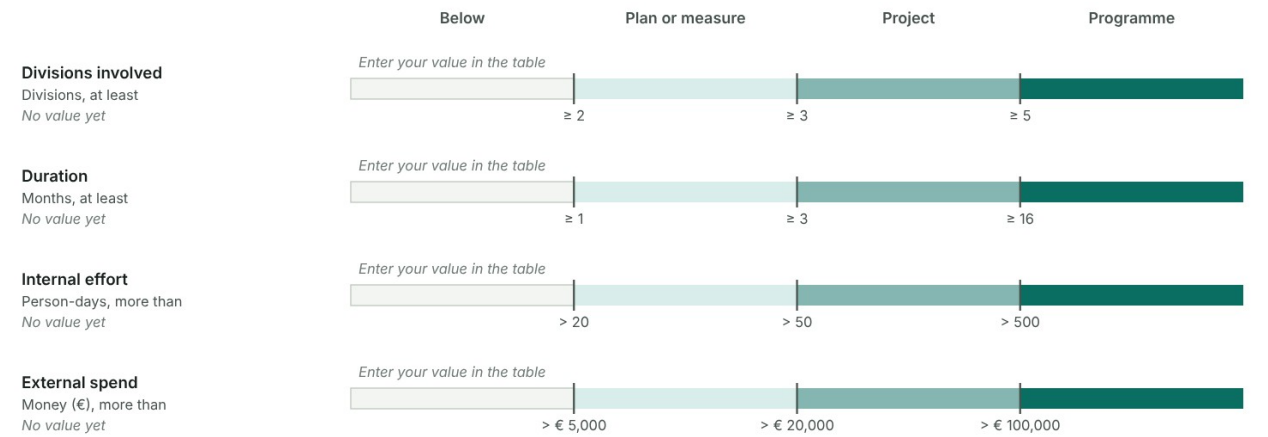
Category criteria

Criterion	Unit	Rule	Plan or measure	Project	Programme	Our project	Reaches
Divisions involved	Divisions	at least					
Duration	Months	at least					
Internal effort	Person-days	more than					
External spend	Money (€)	more than					

Category

Suggested category	
Final category	
Size class	
Worth a project?	
Reason	

Where the project sits



Suggestion: enter your project's values Final category not chosen yet

Figure 10: One scale per criterion. Each band runs from one threshold to the next and has the same width, so small and large numbers read alike. The dot is your project.

First project roles

No.	Role	Person	Appointed on	Appointed by	Note
1	Project owner				
2	Project manager				

From here on the project manager steers the process, usually with a vague brief, a preliminary status and a team that still has to be put together.

3.3 Boundaries and context: the six fields

Mark out what belongs to the project and look at what surrounds it, for time, content and people. The result is the first draft of the Project Charter.

Step record I3: Analyse boundaries and context

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

Method: Why boundaries and context

- Only what is clearly defined can be planned, controlled and measured.
- Boundaries are the inside view: what belongs to the project and what does not. They become the Project Charter.
- Context is the outside view: what came before, what comes after, what runs alongside and who is affected. Knowing it is the basis for acceptance.
- Look at both for time, content and people. That gives six fields, the foundation for high-level and detailed planning.
- PO and PM fill them in together, in variants if the scope is still open. The same step covers the stakeholder analysis (3.4) and a first risk assessment (5).

The six fields

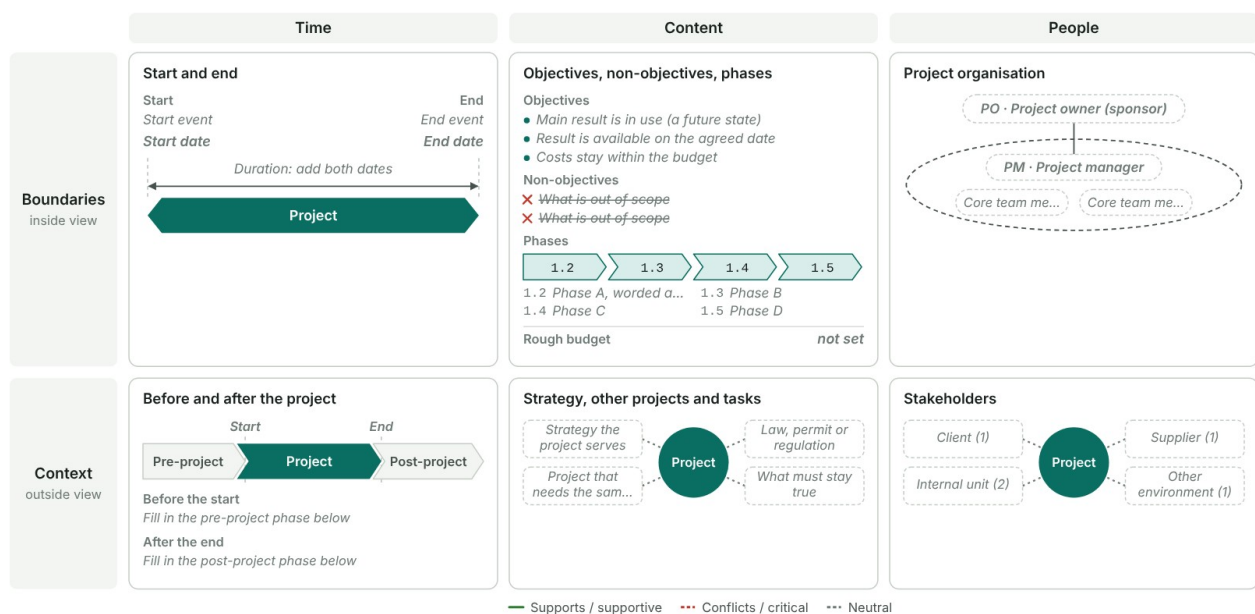


Figure 11: A one-page summary of this section. The top row is the boundary of the project, the bottom row its context. Edges in the context fields show whether a factor or a stakeholder group supports the project or conflicts with it.

Time

Fix start and end as an event and as a date. The event stays when the date moves.

Time boundaries

Start event	
End event	
Start date	
End date	
Duration	

Pre-project phase: the history

What happened before the start	
Decisions already taken	
Documents that exist	
Who supported the project	
Who held it back	

Post-project phase: the consequences

What happens with the results	
Decisions and follow-up projects	
Further benefits	
What we organise during the project for this phase	

Pre-project phase, project, post-project phase

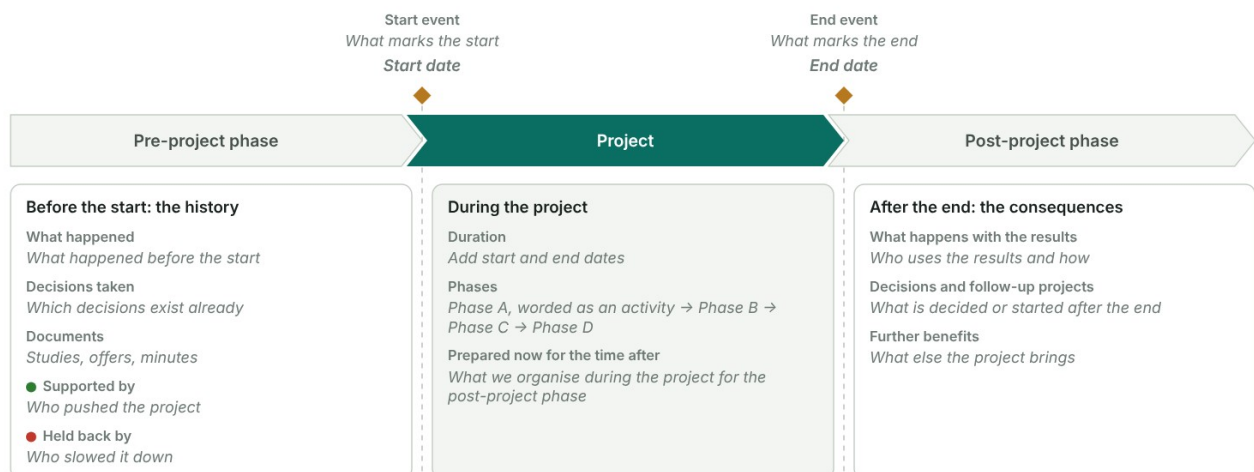


Figure 12: The start and end events (amber) mark the time boundary. Left: what led to the project. Right: what follows from it. The middle card lists what the project prepares now for the time after.

Content

Objectives, non-objectives, phases and a rough budget, and the factors around the project.

Top objective and rough budget

Top objective	
Rough budget	
What the budget covers	

Objectives

No.	Objective	Class	Sub-class	Indicator	Target value	Priority
1		Scope or functional				
2		Schedule				
3		Budget				

Objective pyramid

Top objective
why the project exists

Objective classes
schedule, budget,
scope, procedure

Objectives
with indicator, target
value and priority



No pair of schedule, budget and scope classes is both Must, so the targets leave room to balance.

Figure 13: From the top objective through the objective classes to the measurable objectives. A red outline and "!" mark classes that pull against each other: when schedule, budget or scope both carry a Must objective, decide early which one gives way.

Non-objectives

No.	Non-objective	Why it is out
1		
2		

Phases

WBS	Phase	Main result of the phase	Rough start	Rough end
1.1	Project management			
1.2	Phase A, worded as an activity			
1.3	Phase B			
1.4	Phase C			
1.5	Phase D			

Method: Typical phase models

Phases can be standardised per type of project. Use these as a starting point and keep 4 to 5 phases.

- Construction or investment: engineering → approval by the authorities → procurement → construction and assembly → start-up → training → handover.
- Organisational development: analysis → target concept → pilot phase → roll-out of the full concept → training → introduction.
- Product development: market and internal analysis → feasibility study → development → testing and approval → pilot run → market launch.
- Software development: pre-study → functional concept → IT concept → build → test → training → introduction.

Context: strategy, other projects and outside factors

No.	Factor	Type	Effect	Information and coordination	Contact or shared role
1		Company strategy			
2		Similar or parallel project			
3		Legal			
4		Assumption or critical parameter			

Context of the project

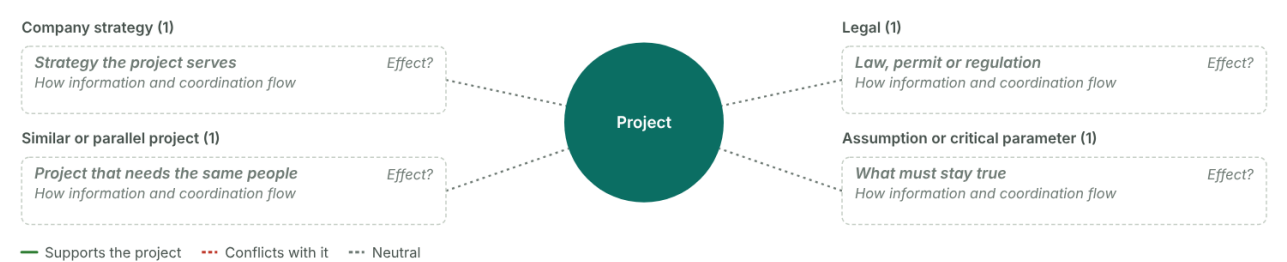


Figure 14: The project in the centre and the factors around it, grouped by type. Green solid edges support the project, red dashed edges conflict with it, grey dotted edges are neutral.

People

Who is inside the project: the project organisation.

Project organisation

No.	Name	Short	Project roles	Department / company	Sub-team	Contact
1			Project owner			
2			Project manager			
3			PMTM			
4			PMTM			

Project organisation (boundary)

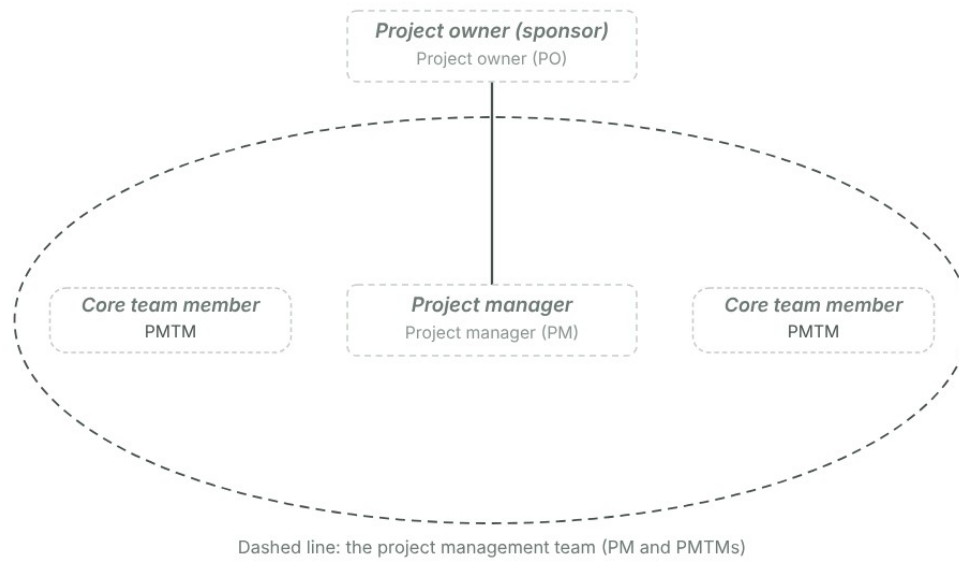


Figure 15: The project owner on top, the project manager below, and the core team (PMTM) around the PM. The dashed line is the boundary of the project management team.

The people context, everyone outside the project who is affected by it and may try to influence it, is the stakeholder analysis in 3.4.

A project that is defined too narrowly misses what it depends on, and vague boundaries invite scope creep. Agree a joint big project picture with the PO and the core team.

3.3 Project Charter

The formal assignment of the project: what it must achieve, by when, with which resources and with whom. PO and PM sign it.

PO, PM and the core team develop it together. It goes to the whole project organisation and to selected stakeholders. The signed version is part of the PM plan.

Charter

Status	
Version	
Date	
Start event	
Start date	
Duration	
End event	
End date	
Business need	

Roles

Project sponsor (PO)	
Project manager	
Project core team	
Project team members	

Objectives

No.	Objective	Class	Sub-class	Indicator	Target value	Priority
1		Scope or functional				
2		Schedule				
3		Budget				

Non-objectives

No.	Non-objective	Why it is out
1		
2		

Main deliverables

No.	Main deliverable	Description	Due
1			
2			
3			

Non-deliverables

No.	Non-deliverable	Note
1		
2		

Project phases

WBS	Phase	Main result of the phase	Rough start	Rough end
1.1	Project management			
1.2	Phase A, worded as an activity			
1.3	Phase B			
1.4	Phase C			
1.5	Phase D			

Resources and costs

No.	Type	What	Quantity	Unit	Cost per unit (€)	Cost (€)
1	Staff (internal)			PD		
2	External labour					
3	Material or investment					
	Total					€ 0

Signatures

Role	Name	Place	Date	Signed
Project owner (sponsor)				
Project manager				

Distribution

No.	Received by	Role	Date
1		Project organisation	
2		Stakeholder	

Project Charter on one page

Project Charter

Project name

Draft

Version and date not set

START
Start event

Start date

END
End event

End date

BUSINESS NEED
Why the organisation needs this project

OBJECTIVES

- Main result is in use (a future state)
- Result is available on the agreed date
- Costs stay within the budget

NON-OBJECTIVES

- What is out of scope
- What is out of scope

MAIN DELIVERABLES

- Main deliverable
- Main deliverable
- Main deliverable

NON-DELIVERABLES

- Not delivered
- Not delivered

PROJECT PHASES

Phase A, worded as an...

Phase B

Phase C

Phase D

Type	Quantity	Cost per unit	Cost
Staff (internal)			
External labour			
Material or investment			
Total			€ 0

PROJECT SPONSOR
Project owner (sponsor)

CORE TEAM
Core team member, Core team member

PROJECT MANAGER
Project manager

TEAM MEMBERS
Team members

SIGNATURES

Project owner (sponsor)

Project owner (sponsor)
Place, date: ...

Project manager

Project manager
Place, date: ...

DISTRIBUTED TO
Project organisation and selected stakeholders

The signed charter is part of the PM plan.

Project Charter

Figure 16: An A4 page in the classic charter layout, ready to print and sign. Long lists are cut with a "+ n more" note; the full lists are in the tables above. Phases leave out project management (1.1).

Charter checks

- × Give the start both an event and a date.
- × Give the end both an event and a date.
- × List at least one objective.
- × List at least one non-objective: it makes the objectives clearer.
- × Name the project owner (sponsor).

- × Name the project manager.
- No one has the role Project manager in the people list yet.
- × Signature not complete (name, date, signed): Project owner (sponsor), Project manager.

3.4 Stakeholder analysis

Find everyone who is affected by the project or can influence it, judge where action is needed, and agree a measure, an owner and a deadline for each.

A good result still fails when the people around the project reject it. Stakeholder management means managing expectations: know who is affected and who has influence, plan what you do for each group, and build the understanding that prevents conflict. It is also the base for project marketing.

Method: The six steps

1. Collect everyone who is affected by the project or holds an opinion about it. Inside: owner, manager, team. Outside: client, management, works council, suppliers, authorities, press, competitors. Start from the people context of the six fields. (Stakeholder table)
2. Sort them into groups and draw them around the project in the stakeholder chart. (Stakeholder table, column Group)
3. Rate how strongly each one is affected and how much influence they have, and mark them supportive, neutral or critical. The need for action follows from that. (Stakeholder table)
4. For each one that needs attention, describe the relation: what each side expects, what they can offer, where conflicts lie. (Measures table)
5. Derive a strategy and concrete measures, linked to a work package where one fits. (Measures table)
6. Give every measure one responsible person and a deadline, and track its status. (Measures table)

The six steps in this file

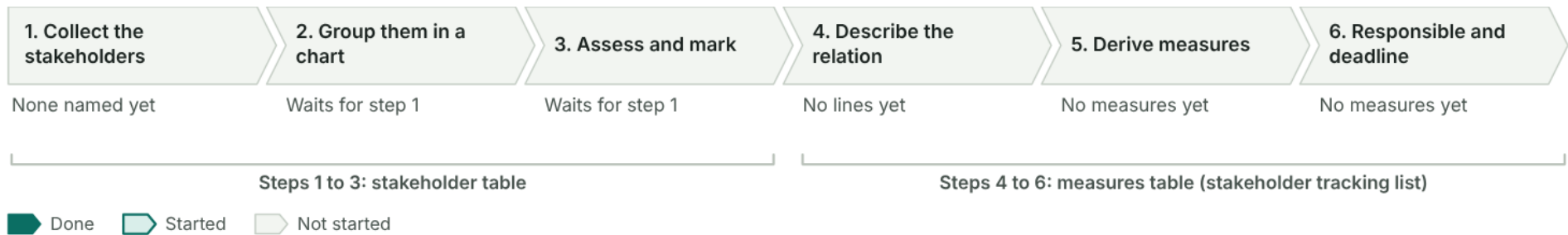


Figure 17: How far each step is filled in. Steps 1 to 3 live in the stakeholder table, steps 4 to 6 in the measures table.

Steps 1 to 3: collect, group and assess

Stakeholder table

No.	Stakeholder	Group	Internal / external	How affected	Influence	Attitude	Need for action	Expectations
1		Client						
2		Internal unit	Internal					
3		Internal unit	Internal					
4		Supplier	External					
5		Other environment	External					

Stakeholder chart



Figure 18: Step 2 and 3: the project in the centre, the stakeholders grouped around it. A red "!" marks critical stakeholders; a thick outline means a high need for action.

Influence and affectedness

Influence on the project



● Supportive ● Neutral ● Critical ○ Attitude not set

Rate how strongly each stakeholder is affected and how much influence they have to place them here.

Figure 19: Step 3: each stakeholder placed by how strongly they are affected and how much influence they have. Those in the top right need the closest attention, especially when critical.

Steps 4 to 6: relation, measures, responsible and deadline

Measures table (stakeholder tracking list)

No.	Stakeholder	Relation	Description of relation	Measure	WBS	Responsible	Deadline	Status
1								
2								
3								

Checks

- No stakeholder has a high need for action yet.
- No measures yet.

3.5 Scope: results plan and work breakdown structure

Scope planning works on three levels: why the project exists, what it delivers and what has to be done. List the results first, then build the work breakdown structure from them.

Step record I4: High-level planning

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

Method: Scope planning in five steps

Steps 1 to 3 happen in the planning workshop. Steps 4 and 5 follow in detailed planning.

1. List the results. Ask what has to exist at the end of the project, tangible or intangible, and break the overall result into partial results.
2. Check the phases against the content boundaries from 3.3 (objectives, exclusions, phases) and put them in process order.
3. Define the work packages within each phase, so that every result comes out of a work package.
4. Give every work package one responsible person.
5. Write a specification for each work package (see 4.2).

Three levels of scope

Each level answers its own question and ends up in its own document.

Scope levels

Level	Guiding question	Document	In our project
1 Objective	Why, and what has to be made possible for whom?	Project Charter, scope statement	
2 Deliverables (interim and final results)	What is supplied? What do we have to think of?	Results plan	
3 Process (tasks)	What has to be done?	Work breakdown structure, WP specifications	

Scope statement and approach

Scope statement	
Planning approach	
Wording of work packages	
Template WBS used	

Results plan

What has to exist at the end of the project, broken down from the overall result.

The results plan is the best completeness check for the WBS: every result needs a work package that produces it.

Results plan

No.	Result	Part of	Type	Description	Produced by
1					
2		Overall result			
3		Overall result			
4		Overall result			
5		Main result 1			
6		Main result 1			

Results plan

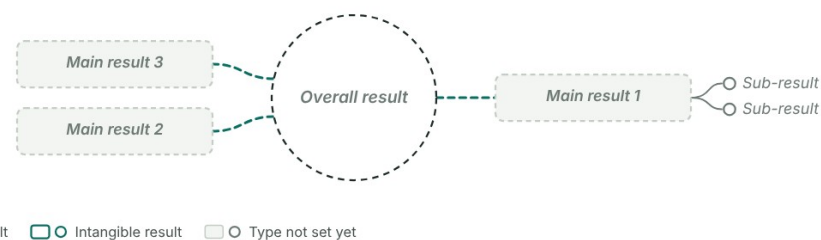


Figure 20: The overall result sits in the centre, main results around it, sub-results branch off them. Filled boxes and dots are tangible results (documents, objects); outlined ones are intangible (services, decisions, knowledge). Set the parent in the "Part of" column.

Work breakdown structure

All the work of the project, by phase. Code 1 is the project, 1.1 is project management, 1.2 onwards are the content phases.

Work breakdown structure

WBS code	Name	Responsible	Result / deliverable	Type
1				Project
1.1	Project management			PM phase
1.1.1	Starting the project			Work package
1.1.2	Coordinating the project			Work package
1.1.3	Controlling the project			Work package
1.1.4	Closing the project			Work package
1.2				Phase
1.2.1				Work package
1.2.2				Work package
1.2.3				Work package
1.3				Phase
1.3.1				Work package
1.3.2				Work package

WBS code	Name	Responsible	Result / deliverable	Type
1.3.3				Work package
1.4				Phase
1.4.1				Work package
1.4.2				Work package
1.4.3				Work package
1.5				Phase
1.5.1				Work package
1.5.2				Work package
1.5.3				Work package

Work breakdown structure

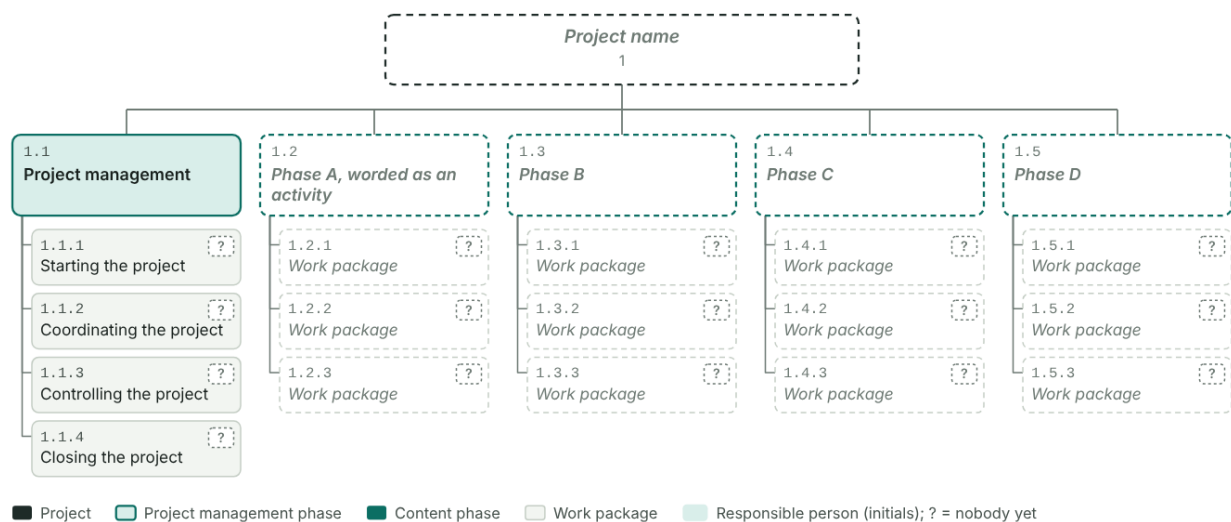


Figure 21: The project on top, the phases in one row with project management first, the work packages below each phase. Tags show who is responsible; a "?" means nobody is assigned yet. More than six phases wrap into a second row.

Work breakdown structure as a process



Figure 22: The content phases in process order, with one square per work package. Project management runs alongside every phase.

WBS rules

- ✓ At least 4 content phases plus the project management phase 1.1. Now: 4 content phases, project management phase present.

- ✓ Every phase has at least 3 work packages.
- × Every work package needs exactly one responsible person. Missing for: 1.1.1, 1.1.2, 1.1.3, 1.1.4, 1.2.1, 1.2.2 and 10 more.
- ✓ All codes are unique and every code has its parent line.
- ✓ Within each phase, all work packages sit on the same level.
- × Name work packages with a noun and a verb, like "building the hull". Found 12 lines without a name yet.
- Wording: 4 of 4 names read as tasks ("building ..."), 0 as results ("... built"). Pick one style and keep it.
- No results named yet. Fill in the results plan to check the WBS for completeness.
- Work packages without a result: 1.1.1, 1.1.2, 1.1.3, 1.1.4, 1.2.1, 1.2.2 and 10 more. Add one in the WBS or link one from the results plan.
- Project management phase 1.1 covers start, coordination, controlling and closing.

3.5 Schedule: milestones and bar chart

Turn the WBS into dates: milestones first, then a phase plan and a bar chart. Estimate how long each work package takes.

Method: How to build the schedule

Inputs: the time boundaries with any fixed deadlines, the WBS, and first assumptions about who works on what.

1. Pick the tools that fit the project and the people who will read the plan (table below).
2. Mark the time-critical events as milestones in the WBS.
3. Move them into the milestone plan.
4. Estimate the duration of each work package and set start and end dates.
5. Draw the high-level schedule: a phase plan with the milestones. The detailed schedule with links follows in the start process (4.2).

Method: No project without a milestone plan

1. Find the time-critical events and place them as milestones in the WBS.
2. Copy them into the milestone plan and word each one as an event ("... completed").
3. Give each a realistic date, top-down from the deadline or bottom-up from the work packages.
4. Freeze these baseline dates once the sponsor approves the project.
5. During controlling, fill in the revised and actual dates.

Scheduling tools

Tool	Content	Use	Used in our project?	Who reads it
Milestone plan	Time-critical events (duration 0) with baseline, revised and actual dates	Plans the critical dates at a high level and focuses the team		
Schedule list	All work packages with start and end date	Detailed dates when there are only a few work packages		
Bar chart	Work packages as bars on a timeline	Makes the dates visible at a glance		
Linked bar chart	Bars plus the links between predecessors and successors	Shows dependencies; lets you simulate changes		
Network diagram	Work packages and dependencies as a network with earliest and latest dates	Shows float and the critical path; for complex projects		

Milestones

Events with no duration that mark the start or end of a work package or phase.

Milestone plan

No.	WBS	Milestone	Type	Baseline	Revised	Actual	Shift
1		Project started	Internal				
2			Internal				
3			Internal				
4			Internal				
5			Internal				
6		Project completed	Internal				

Milestone rules

- × Phases without a milestone: 1.1 Project management, 1.2 Phase A, worded as an activity, 1.3 Phase B, 1.4 Phase C, 1.5 Phase D. Link a milestone to the phase or one of its work packages (WBS column).
- ✓ All milestones are worded as events.
- × Without a baseline date: Project started, Project completed.
- Set the project start and end dates (time boundaries) to compare the number of milestones with the controlling cycles.
- All milestones are internal. Mark the ones a customer, an authority or another outside party sees as external.

Duration estimates

Estimate per work package before you set dates.

Duration estimates per work package

WBS	Work package	Method	Optimistic	Realistic	Pessimistic	Three-point	Spread	Amount of work	Output per day	Analytical	Planned	Fixed start	Basis and assumptions
1.1.1	Starting the project												
1.1.2	Coordinating the project												
1.1.3	Controlling the project												
1.1.4	Closing the project												
1.2.1	Work package												
1.2.2	Work package												
1.2.3	Work package												
1.3.1	Work package												
1.3.2	Work package												
1.3.3	Work package												
1.4.1	Work package												
1.4.2	Work package												
1.4.3	Work package												
1.5.1	Work package												
1.5.2	Work package												
1.5.3	Work package												

Dates

Planned (baseline) and actual dates per work package.

Dates per work package

WBS	Name	Start	End	Days	Predecessors	Actual start	Actual end	Done (%)
1	Project name							
1.1	Project management							
1.1.1	Starting the project							
1.1.2	Coordinating the project							
1.1.3	Controlling the project							
1.1.4	Closing the project							
1.2	Phase A, worded as an activity							
1.2.1	Work package							
1.2.2	Work package							
1.2.3	Work package							
1.3	Phase B							
1.3.1	Work package							
1.3.2	Work package							
1.3.3	Work package							
1.4	Phase C							
1.4.1	Work package							
1.4.2	Work package							
1.4.3	Work package							
1.5	Phase D							
1.5.1	Work package							
1.5.2	Work package							
1.5.3	Work package							

3.5 Resources and costs

Plan who is needed, how many person-days and what it costs, per phase or work package. Every table and chart below comes from the one cost plan.

Method: How to plan resources and costs

Build on the WBS and the schedule, and on the experience of the people who will do the work. Plan it together with the team.

1. Choose the resource types (divisions or qualifications) and the cost types you plan with.
2. Decide the planning depth: per phase for a rough plan, per work package for a detailed one.
3. For each phase or work package, plan the person-days per resource type and the other costs.
4. Merge the lines into the staff placement table and the cost table.
5. Check with the line managers that the people and the budget are available.
6. Optional: spread person-days and costs over the schedule (section 4.2).
7. Optional: draw the histograms and the cumulative cost curve (section 4.2).

Who is needed, with which qualification? How many person-days, and when? From where: internal or bought in? Are they available then? Staff cost = person-days × internal cost rate.

Derive the staffing from the WBS, the work package specifications and the RACI chart. Plan critical resources in detail. Make sure actual values can be measured later, for example by booking time on WBS codes.

Step 1: resource and cost types

Resource types

No.	Resource type	Unit	Cost rate (€)	Available	From	Note
1	Project management	PD			Internal	
2		PD			Internal	
3		PD			Internal	
4	External specialist	PD			External	

Project cost types

Project cost type	Accounting cost types grouped here	Plan (€)
Staff		
External labour		
Material or investment		
Other		
Total		€ 0

Steps 2 and 3: depth and the plan per line

Planning depth	
----------------	--

Resource and cost plan

No.	WBS	Resource or cost type	Cost type	Quantity	Unit	Cost per unit (€)	Plan (€)	Actual (€)	Remaining (€)	Forecast (€)	Deviation (€)	Note
1		Project management	Staff		PD							
2												
3		External labour	External labour		—							
4		Material or investment	Material or investment		—							
5		Other	Other		—							
	Total						€ 0	€ 0	€ 0	€ 0	€ 0	

Step 4: staff placement and cost table

Staff placement table

Built from the cost plan: person-days per WBS line and resource type. Actual and remaining are converted from money with the rate of the line.

WBS	Phase / WP	Resource type	Plan (PD)	Actual (PD)	Remaining (PD)	Forecast (PD)	Deviation (PD)

Cost table

Built from the cost plan: costs per WBS line and project cost type.

WBS	Phase / WP	Cost type	Plan (€)	Actual (€)	Remaining (€)	Forecast (€)	Deviation (€)

Step 5: availability

Checks

- Add lines with quantities or amounts to the cost plan to run the checks.

Steps 6 and 7 (spreading over time, histograms, cost curve) are in section 4.2.

3.6 Project approval

The project owner and the project manager meet face to face to authorise the planning so far. The result is the (preliminarily) released Project Charter.

Step record I5: Project approval

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

Approval meeting

Date	
Place	
Format	
Participants	
Project Charter	
Business case verified	

Agenda of the approval meeting

- ☐ Authorise the current planning
- ☐ Decide how to go forward
- ☐ Verify the investment appraisal (business case)
- ☐ Approve the project and the further planning process
- ☐ Agree the PM plan draft

Approval path



Figure 23: The two gates of the method. The project approval (I5) releases the charter, at least preliminarily, and opens the project start process. The PM plan approval (S5) confirms the final charter and the PM plan and freezes the baseline. Dates and decisions come from this section and from 4.5.

Decisions and conditions

No.	Decision	Condition or requirement	Owner	Due
1				
2				

Open points

No.	Open point	Owner	Due	Status
1				
2				

A preliminarily released charter lets the start process begin while some conditions are still open. Give each condition an owner and a date, and confirm the final charter in step S5.

4.1 Project organisation

Set up who steers, who leads and who works in the project, what each role may decide, and how the project sits in the line organisation.

Step record S1: Establish the project organisation

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

Method: Principles

Plan the organisation on purpose once the charter is released.

- Start from the scope plan: bring in every unit and every kind of know-how the work packages need, internal and external.
- Everyone responsible for a work package belongs to the core team.
- Make the paths for information and decisions clear: who informs whom, who decides what.
- Settle the sub-teams, functional or interdisciplinary, and what each of them may decide.

Method: Six steps

1. Draw the organisation chart.
2. Describe the roles.
3. Set up the communication plan (next section).
4. Agree the cultural elements (next section).
5. Check the organisational incorporation.
6. Optional: create a RACI chart (section 4.2).

People and roles

No.	Name	Short	Project roles	Department / company	Sub-team	Contact
1			Project owner			
2			Project manager			
3			PMTM			
4			PMTM			

Sub-teams

No.	Sub-team	Type	Lead	Members	Decision power	Meets
1						
2						

Organisation chart

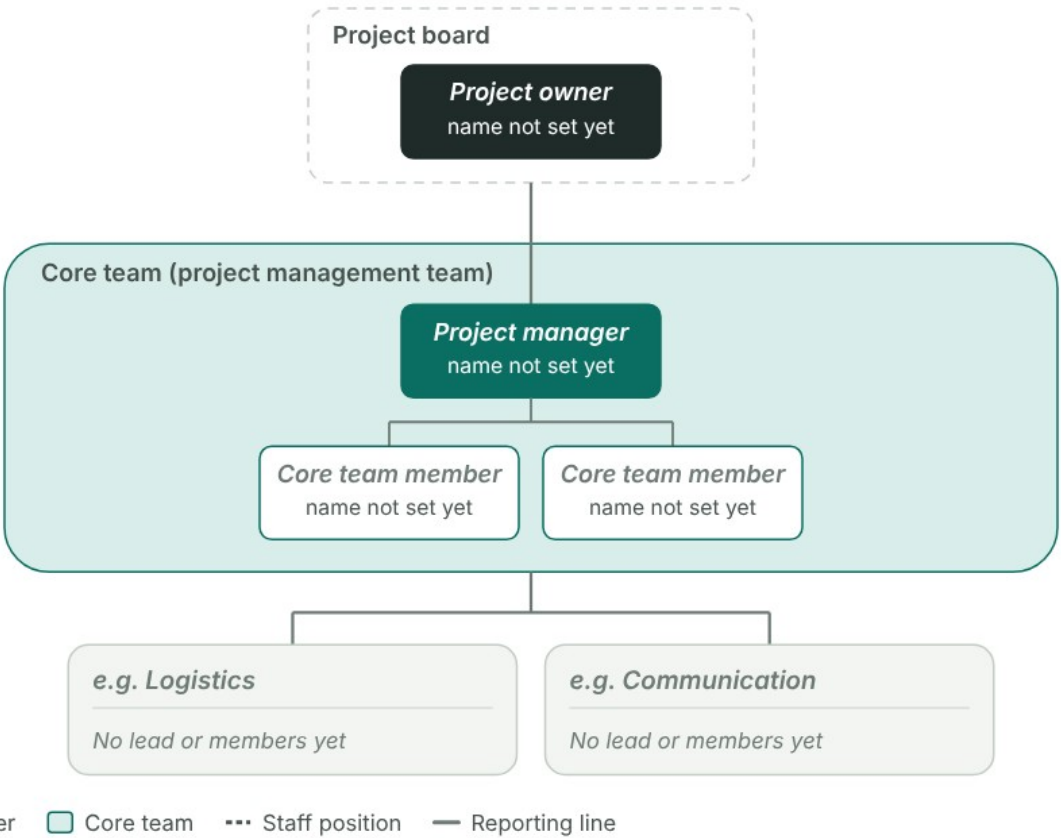


Figure 24: The board with the project owner on top, the PM and the core team in the band, staff positions beside the PM and the sub-teams below. People with a sub-team that is not in the table form their own sub-team.

Role descriptions

Each role has tasks, powers and responsibilities. Roles are independent of people; one person often holds several.

Roles

No.	Role	Kind	Tasks	Powers	Responsibilities	Held by
1	Project owner	Individual				
2	Project manager	Individual				
3	Project management team member	Individual				
4	Project team member	Individual				
5	Project board	Group				
6	Project management team	Group				
7	Project team(s)	Group				

Mutual expectations

No.	From role	To role	Expectation	Agreed
1	Project owner	Project manager		
2	Project manager	Project owner		

Mutual expectations

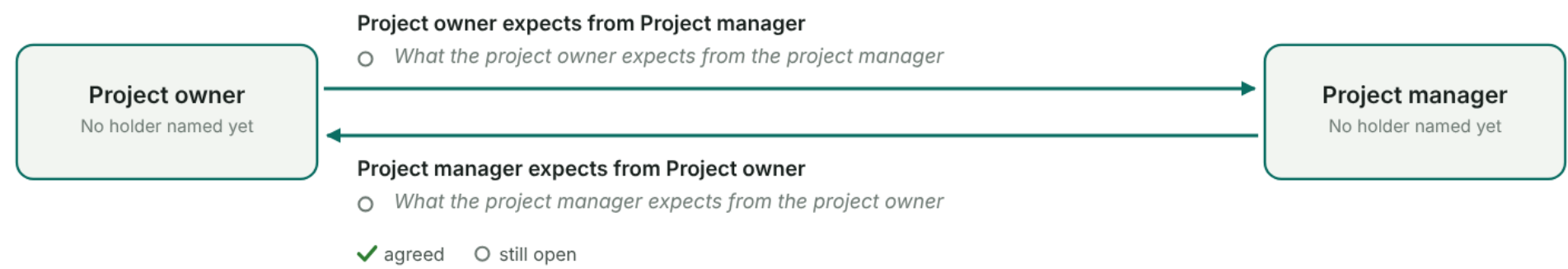


Figure 25: The pair of roles with the most expectations, facing each other. The upper list is what the left role expects, the lower list what the right role expects.

Organisational incorporation

The form of organisation settles who decides about a team member: the line manager or the PM.

Who decides?

Question	Content side	Staff side	Influence	Matrix	Pure project	Content side	Staff side
What?	Work package, content	Tasks, competencies	Line	PM	PM		
When?	WP dates, deadlines	Holidays, time off	Line	PM	PM		
How?	Methods, procedures	Qualifications, equipment	Line	Line	PM		
How good?	Quality	Performance assessment	Line	Line	PM		
How much?	Resources, costs	Salary, bonus	Line	PM	PM		
Who?	Responsible person for the WP	Selection of team members	Line	Line	PM		

Form of organisation

Form we use	
Closest to your answers	
Why this form	

The three forms compared

Form	Position of the PM	Advantages	Disadvantages	Fits us?
Influence organisation	Coordinates from a staff position without authority to decide	Team members stay in their departments; continuous workload; heads of department keep control of the resources	Long decision paths; line work often comes first; low identification with the project; escalation through the line is laborious	
Pure project organisation	Leads a temporary organisational unit with full authority to decide	Full concentration on the project; fast decisions; strong identification	Staff have to be released and re-integrated; continuous workload for project staff has to be ensured; people may lose touch with the home organisation	
Matrix organisation	Cross-sectional function with responsibility for the whole project	Flexible use of staff; specialists are coordinated; team members stay anchored in their departments	Team members report twice; resource management is demanding; highest coordination effort of the three	

Organisational incorporation

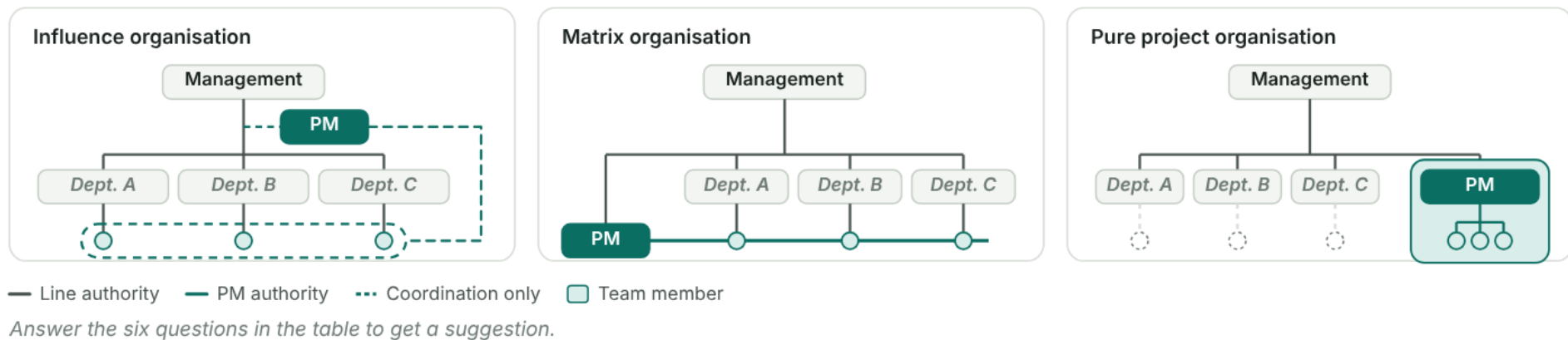


Figure 26: The line organisation with its departments and the project side by side. The large panel shows the chosen form (or the suggested one); the two small panels show the other forms for comparison. Departments come from the people list.

Checks

- × Name the project owner and the project manager in the people list.
- Assign responsible persons to the work packages to check the core team.
- × Roles without a holder: Project owner, Project manager, Project management team member, Project team member, Project board, Project management team, Project team(s).

4.1 Communication, culture and team development

Plan the regular meetings, agree the culture of the project and follow how the team grows together.

Method: Communication plan

- Set clear paths for information and decisions, and cover the regular needs, including information for stakeholders.
- Keep content meetings apart from project management meetings.
- Choose the form by purpose: one-to-one talk, meeting, workshop or presentation.
- Give every regular meeting a chair, a rhythm and someone who writes the minutes.

Communication plan

No.	Meeting	Objectives and content	Participants	Chair	Rhythm	First date	Place	Form	Kind	Minutes by
1	Project board meeting	Present progress; discuss deviations with causes and measures; take the decisions the controlling meeting asks for; approve the progress report	PO, PM, board members		Every 4 weeks			Meeting	Project management	
2	Project controlling meeting	Project status; controlling of scope, dates, resources and costs; stakeholder relations and risks; overarching problems; prepare decisions for the board; next steps	PM, core team members		Every 4 weeks			Meeting	Project management	
3	Sub-team meeting	Coordinate the sub-team; discuss content topics and the decisions they need; plan next steps	Sub-team		As required			Meeting	Content	
4	Project start workshop	Work out planning and organisation together; agree roles, meetings and ground rules	PM, core team, team members		Once			Workshop	Project management	
5	Kick-off meeting	Present the results so far and brief the whole team	PO, PM, core team, team members		Once			Presentation	Project management	

Project culture

Every project has its own culture, which can differ from the company's. Name, logo, slogan, roles, ground rules, rituals and the style of management give it an identity.

Identity

Project name	
Slogan	
Logo	
Style of management and communication	

Ground rules

No.	Rule	Why	Agreed on
1	No deputies		
2	Minutes are binding		
3	E-mail is the primary channel		
4	Phones off in meetings		
5	We give and receive feedback		

Rituals and social events

No.	What	When	Who
1			
2			

Team development

Teams go through five phases. Watch for the signs and steer: give orientation early, settle conflicts, delegate once the norms hold, close with a joint review.

Team phases

Phase	Typical signs	When	What we noticed	What the PM did
Forming	Polite, careful, insecure			
Storming	Conflicts, unclear roles, slow progress			
Norming	Ground rules, roles settle, feedback			
Performing	Efficient, flexible, mutual support			
Adjourning	Joint review, taking in what was learned			

Team development

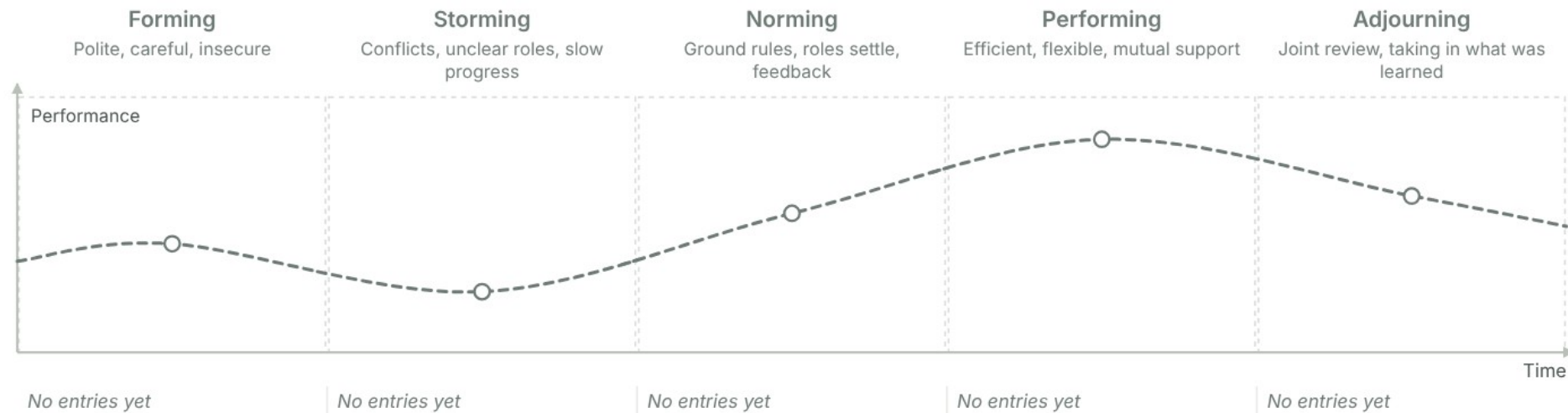


Figure 27: Performance over time through the five phases, with the dip in storming. Under each phase: when it happened and what the PM did. Phases without entries are drawn muted.

Checks

- ✓ The plan has a board meeting.
- ✓ The plan has a controlling meeting.
- ✓ Content and project management meetings are kept apart.
- × Chair or minute-taker missing: Project board meeting, Project controlling meeting.
- × 5 ground rule(s) not agreed with the team yet.

4.2 Who does what: RACI chart

Decide for every work package who leads it, who works on it, who approves it and who is kept informed.

Step record S2: Detailed planning

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

Method: Three ways to record who does what

Pick the level of detail the project needs. Each way adds to the one before.

1. A list with the responsible person for each work package.
2. Names or initials written into the WBS or the bar chart.
3. A RACI chart: work packages as rows, people or roles as columns, a letter in each cell where someone is involved.

Method: The four letters

R and C are always used. A and I are optional; add them when approvals or reporting lines need to be clear.

- R, responsible: leads the work package and delivers its result. Exactly one per work package.
- C, contributes: works on the package and supplies part of the result.
- A, accountable: approves the result, often the project owner.
- I, informed: hears about progress and results, without working on them.

The chart makes responsibilities explicit, gives target agreements a base, shows every person the number and kind of their tasks, and helps in conflicts and when planning staff.

Make a first version now and complete it once the work package specifications are written. The specifications show who really has to contribute.

Columns

People shown as columns	All people
-------------------------	------------

RACI chart

WBS	Work package	PO	PM	PMTM 1	PMTM 2	People
1.1.1	Starting the project					
1.1.2	Coordinating the project					
1.1.3	Controlling the project					
1.1.4	Closing the project					
1.2.1	Work package					
1.2.2	Work package					
1.2.3	Work package					
1.3.1	Work package					
1.3.2	Work package					
1.3.3	Work package					
1.4.1	Work package					
1.4.2	Work package					
1.4.3	Work package					
1.5.1	Work package					
1.5.2	Work package					
1.5.3	Work package					

Checks

- Put R, C, A or I into the chart to run the checks.

RACI matrix

WBS	Work package	PO	PM	PMTM 1	PMTM 2	People
1.1	Project management					
1.1.1	Starting the project					
1.1.2	Coordinating the project					
1.1.3	Controlling the project					
1.1.4	Closing the project					
1.2	Phase A, worded as an activity					
1.2.1	Work package					
1.2.2	Work package					
1.2.3	Work package					
1.3	Phase B					
1.3.1	Work package					
1.3.2	Work package					
1.3.3	Work package					
1.4	Phase C					
1.4.1	Work package					
1.4.2	Work package					
1.4.3	Work package					
1.5	Phase D					
1.5.1	Work package					
1.5.2	Work package					
1.5.3	Work package					
Work packages per person		-	-	-	-	

R Responsible C Contributes A Accountable I Informed

Figure 28: The chart as a picture for the PM plan, grouped by phase. The last column counts the people per work package, the last row the work packages per person. A red code marks a row without an R or with more than one.

4.2 Work package specifications

Describe the larger or riskier work packages in a short, agreed form, so that the responsible person and the PM mean the same thing.

Method: What a specification is for

It gives the PM and the work package owner the same picture, avoids duplicated work and idle time, makes schedule, staff and cost estimates more reliable and makes progress measurable.

1. Settle who is responsible for each work package (RACI chart) and choose the work packages that need a specification.
2. Agree a template if the one below does not fit.
3. Define the specifications together with the whole team.
4. Each responsible person works out the specification for their work package.
5. Agree the specifications in the team, across all disciplines.
6. Adapt, detail or extend the schedule, staff and cost plans where needed.

Split a long work package into a few visible steps and give each the share of work done when it is reached, for example "offers in = 25%". Progress is then counted, not guessed.

Which work packages need a specification

WBS	Work package	Responsible	Needs a specification	Status	Note
1.1.1	Starting the project				
1.1.2	Coordinating the project				
1.1.3	Controlling the project				
1.1.4	Closing the project				
1.2.1	Work package				
1.2.2	Work package				
1.2.3	Work package				
1.3.1	Work package				
1.3.2	Work package				
1.3.3	Work package				
1.4.1	Work package				
1.4.2	Work package				
1.4.3	Work package				
1.5.1	Work package				
1.5.2	Work package				
1.5.3	Work package				

Work package specification (form)

WBS code and name	
Responsible	
Content	
Non-content	
Results	
Measuring progress	
Duration	
Resources	
Predecessors	
Notes	

Checks

- Mark the work packages that need a specification in the column "Needs a specification".

4.2 Detailed schedule: linked bar chart and network

Link the work packages, find the critical path and see how much float each one has.

Method: From bar chart to linked bar chart

The schedule is finalised from the WP specifications. Network analysis is the most demanding method; use it for complex projects.

1. Give every work package a duration and name what it depends on.
2. Draw the bars with their links.
3. Calculate forwards and backwards: earliest and latest dates and the float. The chain without float is the critical path.
4. Check the result against the resource plan and fixed dates, and optimise.

Method: Accuracy grows step by step

1. Rough: phases and milestones (initiation, 3.5).
2. Detailed: work packages with dates and the main dependencies.
3. Verified detailed: based on the WP specifications and the resource plan.

Give each reader the level they need: the sponsor the milestone plan, the core team the phase plan, work package owners the detailed bars. A detailed bar chart is rarely useful in a controlling meeting.

Types of dependency

Type	Name	Meaning	Write it as	Example	Used
FS	Finish-to-start	B can start when A has ended	1.2.1 or 1.2.1 FS+5	Set-up starts once the catering contract is signed	
SS	Start-to-start	B can start when A has started	1.2.1 SS+10	Registrations open 10 days after the invitation design starts	
FF	Finish-to-finish	B can end when A has ended	1.2.1 FF	Testing ends when development ends	
SF	Start-to-finish	B can end when A has started	1.2.1 SF	The old system runs until the new one starts	

Type the predecessors in the table below: "1.2.1" is finish-to-start, "1.3.2 SS" start-to-start, "1.4.1 FS+5" finish-to-start with 5 days lag, "1.4.1 SS-2" starts 2 days before. Separate several with a comma or semicolon. A phase code such as "1.3" stands for all its work packages.

Dates and predecessors

WBS	Name	Start	End	Days	Predecessors	Actual start	Actual end	Done (%)
1	Project name							
1.1	Project management							
1.1.1	Starting the project							
1.1.2	Coordinating the project							

WBS	Name	Start	End	Days	Predecessors	Actual start	Actual end	Done (%)
1.1.3	Controlling the project							
1.1.4	Closing the project							
1.2	Phase A, worded as an activity							
1.2.1	Work package							
1.2.2	Work package							
1.2.3	Work package							
1.3	Phase B							
1.3.1	Work package							
1.3.2	Work package							
1.3.3	Work package							
1.4	Phase C							
1.4.1	Work package							
1.4.2	Work package							
1.4.3	Work package							
1.5	Phase D							
1.5.1	Work package							
1.5.2	Work package							
1.5.3	Work package							

Network settings

Left out of the network	
-------------------------	--

Critical path

Calculated from the durations and predecessors. Day 0 is the project start.

Earliest and latest dates per work package

WBS	Work package	Responsible	Duration from	Duration	ES	EF	LS	LF	TF	FF	Critical	Earliest start	Latest finish	Planned start
1.1.1	Starting the project		Missing											
1.1.2	Coordinating the project		Missing											
1.1.3	Controlling the project		Missing											
1.1.4	Closing the project		Missing											

WBS	Work package	Responsible	Duration from	Duration	ES	EF	LS	LF	TF	FF	Critical	Earliest start	Latest finish	Planned start
1.2.1	Work package		Missing											
1.2.2	Work package		Missing											
1.2.3	Work package		Missing											
1.3.1	Work package		Missing											
1.3.2	Work package		Missing											
1.3.3	Work package		Missing											
1.4.1	Work package		Missing											
1.4.2	Work package		Missing											
1.4.3	Work package		Missing											
1.5.1	Work package		Missing											
1.5.2	Work package		Missing											
1.5.3	Work package		Missing											

Network checks

- ✓ All predecessor codes exist in the WBS.
- ✓ No loops in the dependencies.
- ✗ No dates and no estimate, so not in the calculation: 1.1.1, 1.1.2, 1.1.3, 1.1.4, 1.2.1, 1.2.2 and 10 more.

4.2 Detailed resources and costs: over time

The cost plan of section 3.5 at work package level, spread over the months of the schedule: staff per month, costs per month, the cost curve and the payments.

Method: Resources and costs at work package level

- Staff allocation plan: person-days per work package for each resource type or department.
- Cost plan: cost per work package for each project cost type. The many accounting cost types are grouped into four: staff, external labour, material or investment, other.
- Spread both over the schedule: each line evenly over the calendar days of its work package.
- The resource histogram shows the peaks; check them against what the departments can give.
- The cumulative cost curve has an S shape. It is the cost baseline you control against.
- Set the incoming payments against it to see when costs run ahead of payments. Total billed minus the budget is the gross margin.
- Use the comparison to agree payment plans and as the basis for earned value analysis.

Staff over time

Staff required per month

Planned person-days per resource type and month. Each line is spread evenly over the calendar days of its WBS line.

Resource type	Total

Costs over time

Costs per month

Planned costs per project cost type and month (€, rounded).

Cost type	Total

Payments and gross margin

Incoming payments

No.	Date	Description	Amount (€)	Received
1				
2				
	Total		€ 0	

Total billed	
Gross margin	

Checks

- Add lines to the cost plan (section 3.5) to run the checks.

4.3 Consolidate and coordinate the detailed planning

The plans from the detailed planning are brought together, checked against each other and agreed by the team. Afterwards everyone works from the same validated plans.

Step record S3: Consolidate and coordinate

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

Method: How the plans come together

1. Team members prepare their plans alone or in pairs.
2. In a face-to-face follow-up workshop the team puts the plans side by side: dates, staff, costs and risks must fit each other.
3. Change what does not fit and mark each plan as validated.
4. Set up project marketing so the project is visible to the people it affects.
5. Complex projects may need several planning cycles.

Follow-up workshop

Date	
Place	
Planning cycles	
Participants	

Plan check

Plan	Status	What changed	By	Section
Linked bar chart / schedule				
Staff deployment (resource plan)				
Cost plan				
Risk analysis				
RACI chart				
WP specifications				
Communication plan				
Project marketing				

Consolidation status

8 plans, none checked yet

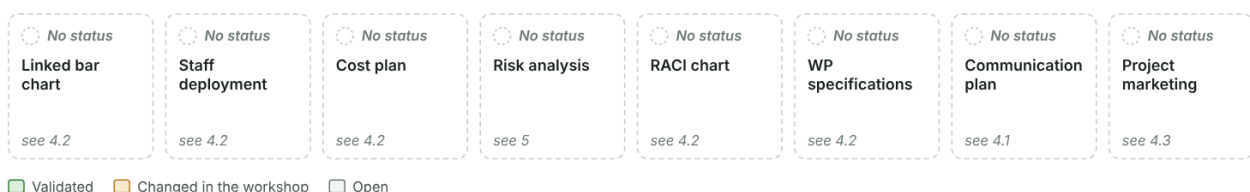


Figure 29: The eight plans at a glance. Green plans are validated, amber plans were changed in the workshop, grey plans are still open. The note shows what changed.

Project marketing

Make the project known to the people it affects, so they support it and are not surprised by it.

Project marketing plan

No.	Measure	Target group	Channel	When	Responsible	Status
1						
2						
3						

4.4 Finalise the PM plan

The PM plan collects every plan of the project in one place. Send it to all core team members and settle the last open points before it goes to the project owner.

Step record S4: Finalise the PM plan

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

Method: What the PM plan does

- Shows the current status of the project at any time.
- Keeps all project management instruments together and consistent.
- Records the project history, which helps when the project manager changes.
- Lets the organisation learn from the project.

Finalising

Sent to all PMTMs on	
Last internal meeting on open points	
Where the PM plan is stored	

Contents of the PM plan

Section	Document	Included	Version	File or location	Owner	Status
3.3	Project Charter					
3.4	Stakeholder analysis					
3.5	Results plan					
3.5	Work breakdown structure (WBS)					
4.2	WP specifications					
3.5	Milestone plan					
3.5, 4.2	Bar chart / schedule					

Section	Document	Included	Version	File or location	Owner	Status
4.2	Network analysis					
3.5, 4.2	Resource plan					
3.5, 4.2	Cost plan					
4.1	Organisation chart					
4.1	Role descriptions					
4.1	Communication plan					
4.1	Ground rules and project culture					
4.2	RACI chart					
5	Risk table					
7	Change request process					
4.3	Project marketing plan					
8	Situational analysis and method check					

Version history

No.	Version	Date	What changed	Author	Sent to
1					
2					

Filing structure

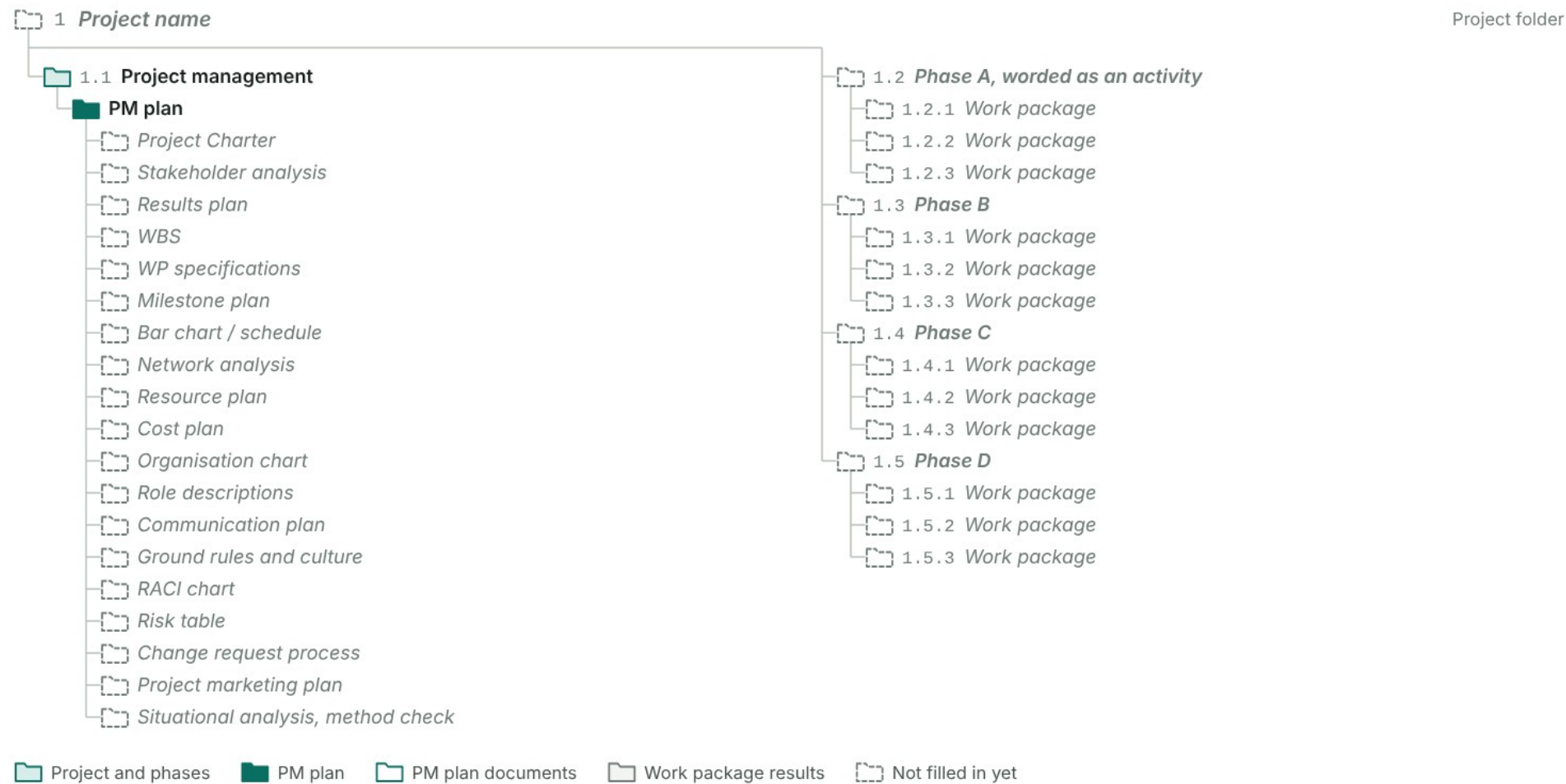


Figure 30: The WBS doubles as the filing structure. The project management phase holds the PM plan with one folder per included document; every other phase holds one folder per work package for its results.

4.5 Approve the PM plan

The project manager presents the planning to the project owner or the steering committee. Their approval of the final charter and the PM plan 1.0 ends the project start process.

Step record S5: Approve the PM plan

Status	
When	
Format used	
Who took part	
What we did	
Result	

Approval meeting

Date	
Format	
Decision	
Participants	
Final charter approved	
Approved PM plan version	
Baseline saved on	

Agreed in the meeting

- ☐ Roles agreed
- ☐ Communication structures agreed
- ☐ Reporting rhythm agreed
- ☐ How changes are handled (change request process) agreed
- ☐ Baseline saved

Baseline

Baseline	Frozen on	Version	Where stored	Note
Milestone baseline				
Schedule baseline				
Cost baseline (S-curve)				
Scope baseline (WBS)				
Risk budget				

Project controlling compares every later status with the baseline: milestones, dates, costs, scope and the risk budget.

Approval checks

- Record the decision on the PM plan.
- Record whether the final charter was approved.
- Save the baseline on the day of approval.
- 0 of 5 agreements ticked

5 Risk management

Find the risks, put a value on them and decide what you do about them. The risk values add up to the risk budget the sponsor approves.

Method: Risk management in four steps

The team does this together and repeats it throughout the project. It builds on the plans and can change them. Some risks will always stay unidentified.

1. Identify: collect risks from the project plans, checklists, content documents, expert interviews, brainstorming and lessons learned. Look at content and quality, dates, and resources and costs.
2. Assess: estimate what the risk would cost if it happens and how likely it is, usually between 5% and 70%. Risk value = risk cost × probability. Work on the highest values first.
3. Plan measures: preventive measures act now, corrective measures are ready for when the risk occurs. Pick a strategy for each risk: avoid, reduce, transfer or accept.
4. Implement and control: put the preventive measures into the WBS and the cost plan. Review the risks regularly, reassess them, add new ones, trigger corrective measures and record the changes.

Risk management in four steps

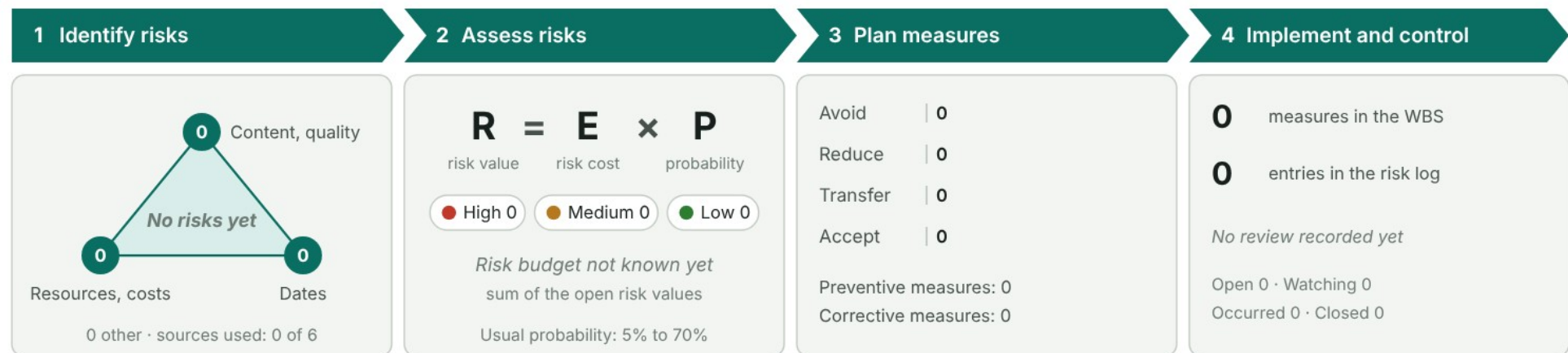


Figure 31: Filled from the risk table and the risk log. Corners of the triangle: risks on content and quality, resources and costs, and dates.

Terms

Term	Meaning	In our project
Risk	A single future event that may affect content and quality, dates, resources or costs. The effect can be negative or positive.	
Crisis	An event that threatens the project as a whole. It goes to the sponsor at once.	
Risk management	Finding and assessing risks, planning measures, carrying them out and checking them.	

Identify and assess

Steps 1 and 2

Sources used	
First risk assessment	
Full risk analysis	

Priority thresholds

High from	
Medium from	

Risk table

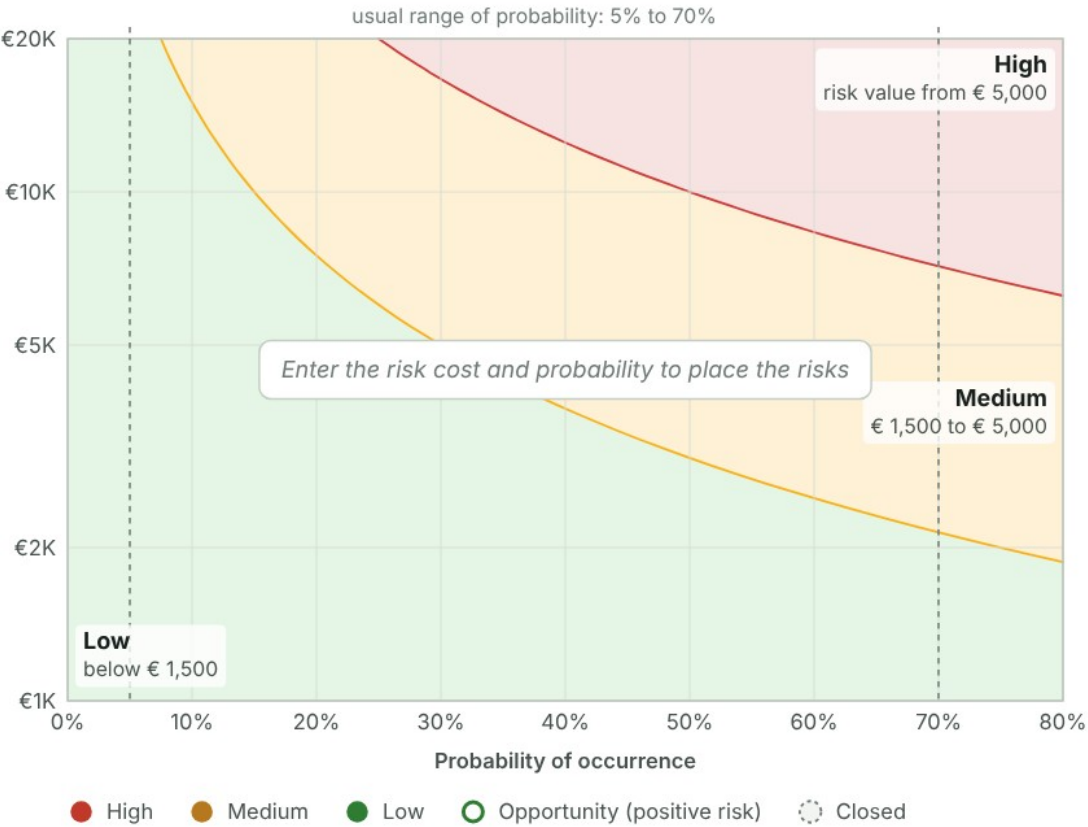
No.	Title	Description and cause	Category	Risk cost (€)	Delay	Probability (%)	Risk value (€)	Priority	Strategy	Preventive measure	WBS of the measure	Cost of prevention (€)	Corrective measure	Owner	Status	Positive
1																
2																
3																
	Total											€ 0				

Totals

Risk budget	
Risk value of all risks	
Cost of prevention	
High risks not closed	

Risk matrix

Risk cost (impact), log scale



No.	Risk	Risk value
1	e.g. Key supplier delivers late	
2	e.g. Key person drops out	
3	e.g. Sponsor cuts the budget	

Figure 32: Each dot is one risk, numbered as in the table. The curved lines are the thresholds: along each line the risk value is the same. Dots that would cover each other are moved aside, with a thin line to their exact spot.

Risk budget and reserves

Risk budget approved by the sponsor	
Approved on	
Time reserve	
Risk budget in the cost plan	

Risk controlling

Step 4

Risk log

Date	Risk	What changed	New probability (%)	New risk cost (€)	Measure triggered	By

Involve as many people as you can, also outside the core team. Build the first risk table on a flip chart. Keep the list to the critical risks you can influence. Use your company's standard risk table if there is one.

Checks

- Add risks to the risk table to run the checks.

6 Kick-off and start workshop

Choose how the team plans together in the start phase, then prepare the kick-off and the start workshop.

Method: Four formats you can combine

Effort and planning quality both rise from the first format to the last. Most projects combine several of them.

- Planning alone: the PM drafts plans at the desk. Quick, but the plan rests on one view.
- One-to-one meetings: the PM works through single topics with the people who know them.
- Kick-off meeting: the PM presents the results so far and briefs the team. Information flows one way.
- Project start workshop: the team works out planning and organisation together. It costs the most effort and gives the best plans and the strongest commitment.

Kick-off meeting and start workshop compared

Aspect	Kick-off meeting	Project start workshop	In our project
Purpose	Present results and brief the team with filtered information	Work out planning and organisation together	
Communication	One way: talk and presentation	Team work; the PM works as part of the project management team	
Effect	Information	Acceptance, motivation and commitment	
Effort	Medium	High: preparation, follow-up and coordination	
Planning quality	Usually low	Usually high	
Duration	2 to 4 hours	Half a day to 2 days	

Formats used in this project

Format	Used	When	Participants	Note
Planning alone				
One-to-one meetings				
Kick-off meeting				
Project start workshop				
Follow-up workshop				

Formats: effort and planning quality

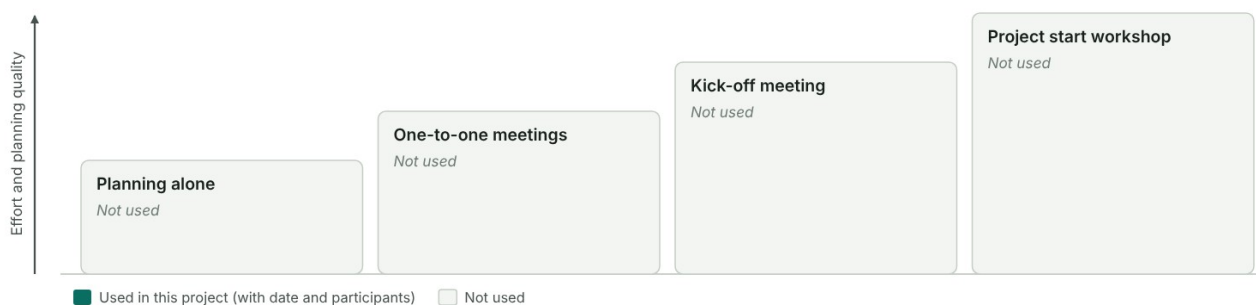


Figure 33: The four formats as steps. Each step up costs more effort and gives better plans. Filled steps are the ones this project used.

Kick-off meeting

A short meeting to inform everyone: what the project is, what has been decided, who does what.

Kick-off

Date	
Duration	
Place	
Participants	

Kick-off agenda

No.	Time	Topic	Presenter	Material
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

Project start workshop

The PM is responsible. Decide what you prepare and present, and what the team works out on the day.

Start workshop

Date	
Duration	
Place	
External location	
Moderation	
Social event	
Participants	

Start workshop agenda

No.	Time	Topic	Method	Result	Responsible	Prepared or worked out
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						

Start workshop checks

- × Enter the participants (3 to 15 work well)
- × Held at an external location, away from daily business
- × The agenda mixes prepared items (0) with items worked out together (0)
- Consider a social event, such as a dinner after the workshop
- The start workshop also counts as a quality measure: the whole team checks the plan.

7 Contract management in customer projects

In a customer project the contract process runs next to the project management process. Keep the two in step.

Set the kind of project on the overview page. For an internal project this page can stay empty.

Method: Two processes side by side

Sales runs the contract process, the PM runs the project. Plan the points where they meet. What makes it hard:

- The project rests on a legal contract that is hard to change.
- The people usually change between the offer and the implementation, so information gets lost when the contract is signed.
- The interests of the parties can contradict each other.
- A valid offer already needs some project planning.
- Contract and project documents repeat each other, for example the description of services.

Contract process in this project

Step	Activities	Roles	Results	When	Who in our project	Status	Note
Acquisition	Evaluate customer expectations, check technical and commercial feasibility, plan the offer process	Sales	Rough business case, first risk assessment, customer requirements, plan for the offer				
Preparation of offer	Plan the offer in detail where needed, prepare its contractual, commercial and content parts, assess risks, get approval	Sales, department	Offer documents, business case and project plans, negotiation strategy				
Contract negotiation	Hand the offer to the customer, take in feedback, appoint the negotiation team, negotiate and sign	Sales, department	Adapted offer, signed contract				
Project handover	Appoint PM and project team, brief the project organisation, release the offer team	Sales, department, PM	Project organisation in place, project assignment, offer team released				
Contract analysis and detailed planning	Analyse the obligations of both parties, find risks and open points, plan the project	PM, PMTMs	Implementation plan, risk analysis, claim and change request strategy				

Contract and project process



① Offer rests on the high-level plan ② Handover is the project start ③ Contract analysis feeds the detailed planning

Done In progress Not started Not applicable

Figure 34: The contract process above, the ten steps of the project below. The numbered points are where both must be in step. The red line marks the signature, where the offer team hands over to the project team.

Contract analysis

After the handover, go through the contract and list what each party has to do, by when, and what is still open.

Obligations from the contract

No.	Obligation	Party	Clause	Due	Risk or open point	WBS
1						
2						

Strategies

Claim strategy	
Change request strategy	

Change request log

No.	Date	Requested by	Description	Scope impact	Schedule impact	Cost impact (€)	Decision	Decided by	Date decided
1									
	Total					€ 0			

8 Tailoring the planning process

Fit the planning process to the project: analyse the situation, choose the methods and line up the steps.

Method: The planning process is a small project of its own

Delimit it like a project: by its start and end events, its content, the people involved, its context and how it relates to your company standard. The PM is responsible and makes it transparent to everyone:

- which steps belong to the initiation and which to the project start,
- which communication formats are used,
- which methods are used, and how deep.

Boundaries of the planning process

Start event	
End event	
Participants	
Context	
Relation to the company standard	

Situation analysis

Rate the project on each criterion. The profile shows what the planning process has to cover and who is needed when.

Situation analysis

Group	Criterion	Rating	Note
Planning situation	Clarity of order or contract		
Planning situation	General planning situation		
Planning situation	Budget situation		
Planning situation	Deadline situation		
Project features	Room for manoeuvre		
Project features	Probable need for changes		
Project features	Level of innovation		
Project features	Technique or content		
Project organisation	Internal participants		

Group	Criterion	Rating	Note
Project organisation	External participants		
Project organisation	Location of the team		
Project organisation	Content experience of the team		
Project organisation	PM experience of the team		
Environment	Relation to stakeholders		
Environment	Relation to the customer		

Result

Critical answers	
Overall profile	

Situation analysis profile

Group	Criterion	Uncritical	Rather uncritical	Rather critical	Critical
Planning situation	Clarity of order or contract	clear and good	satisfactory	unclear	critical
	General planning situation	good	sufficient	little	very little
	Budget situation	non-critical	rather non-critical	rather critical	critical
	Deadline situation	non-critical	rather non-critical	rather critical	critical
Project features	Room for manoeuvre	high flexibility	medium flexibility	low flexibility	no flexibility
	Probable need for changes	small	lower	higher	high
	Level of innovation	small	lower	higher	high
	Technique or content	known	probably known	probably unknown	unknown
Project organisation	Internal participants	0–3	4–7	8–12	more than 12
	External participants	0	1–3	4–6	more than 6
	Location of the team	on site	same country	within the EU	rest of the world
	Content experience of the team	good	fairly good	less experienced	inexperienced
	PM experience of the team	good	fairly good	less experienced	inexperienced
Environment	Relation to stakeholders	good	fairly good	not very good	bad
	Relation to the customer	good	fairly good	not very good	bad

Rate each criterion in the table above to draw the profile.

Figure 35: One row per criterion, from uncritical on the left to critical on the right. The chosen answers are joined into a profile line; the further right it runs, the more care the planning needs.

What the profile means for the planning process

Method check

For every method, decide whether it already exists, is prepared in the initiation or in the start process, or is not needed. The list is also the content of the PM plan.

Method check

Method or document	Level	Usual timing	Section	Decision	Depth	Note
Project assignment (charter)	Foundation	Initiation, finalised in the start process	3.3			
Stakeholder analysis	Foundation	Initiation	3.4			
List of deliverables, results plan	Compulsory (base camp)	Initiation	3.5			
Work breakdown structure	Compulsory (base camp)	Initiation	3.5			
Milestone plan	Compulsory (base camp)	Initiation	3.5			
Resource plan	Compulsory (base camp)	Initiation, detailed in the start process	3.5, 4.2			
Cost plan	Compulsory (base camp)	Initiation, detailed in the start process	3.5, 4.2			
Organisation chart	Organisation	Start process	4.1			
Definition of roles	Organisation	Start process	4.1			
Communication plan	Organisation	Start process	4.1			
Ground rules	Organisation	Start process	4.1			
RACI chart	Organisation	Start process	4.2			
WP specification	Optional (detailed)	Start process	4.2			
Linked bar chart or network plan	Optional (detailed)	Start process	4.2			
Risk analysis, qualitative or quantitative	All levels, grows with complexity	First assessment in initiation, full analysis in the start process	5			
Contract analysis	External projects	After the project handover	7			
Change request process	Additional	Start process	7			
Project marketing	Additional	Start process				

Method pyramid

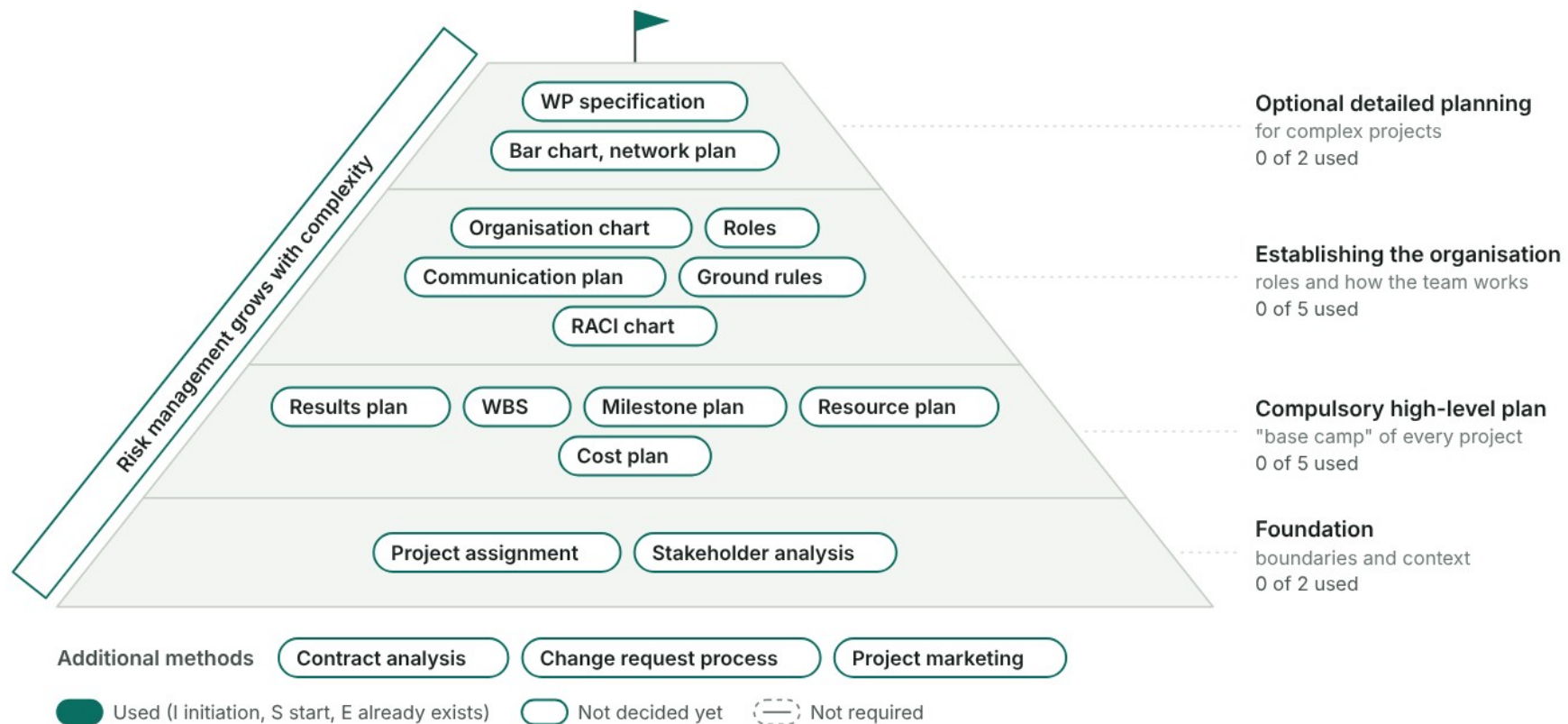


Figure 36: The more complex the project, the further up the pyramid the planning goes. Risk management runs up the side because it grows with complexity. Each method is styled by its decision in the method check.

Tailoring checks

- × Start and end event of the planning process defined
- × 0 of 15 situation criteria rated
- × 0 of 18 methods decided
- ✓ No foundation or base camp method is skipped
- Contract analysis is only needed for customer projects.

Planning navigator

A project runs on five process levels that shift against each other. The navigator lines them up.

Method: Four steps to your navigator

- 1. Take the generic project management process: initiation, then start.
- 2. Define the planning and communication steps and assign them to it.
- 3. Define the content phases of the project.
- 4. Assign deliverables and project management methods to the steps.

Navigator of this project

Process	Planning and communication steps	Content phases covered	Deliverables	PM methods
Initiation				
Start				

Planning navigator

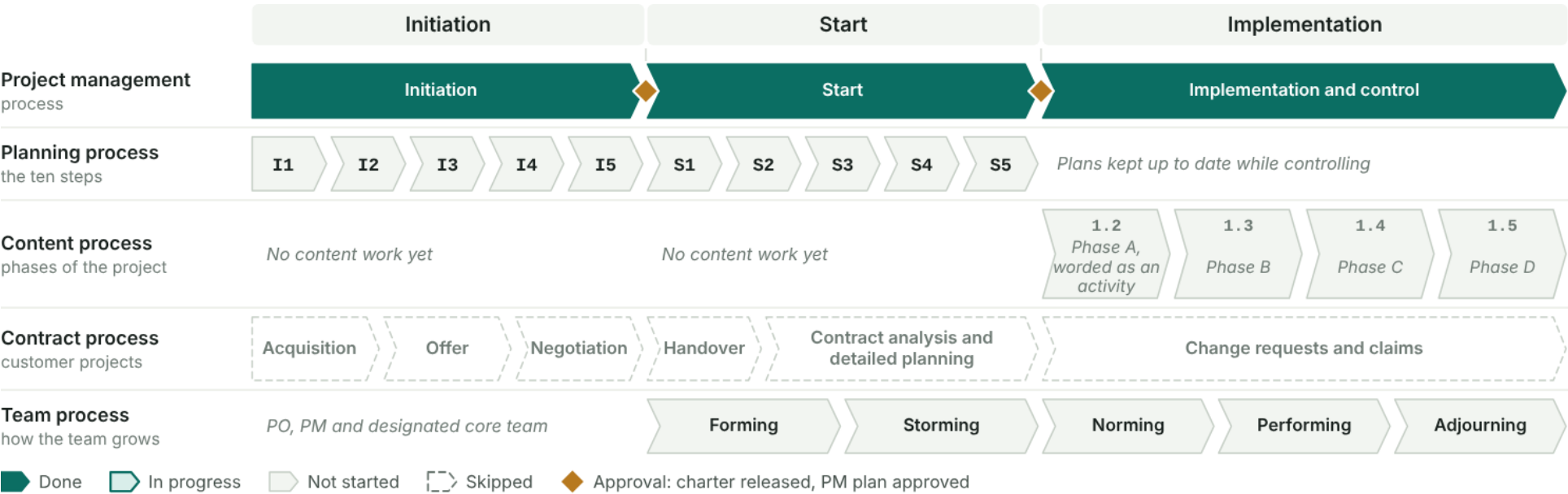


Figure 37: Five process levels under one header. Positions are relative, not dates. The planning steps take their colours from the step records; the content phases come from the WBS and the table above.

Large external or small internal project

Aspect	Large external project	Small internal project	Our project
Initiation	Assess the idea, categorise, boundaries and context, rough and detailed planning, consolidate and compile the PM plan, approval	Assess the idea or task, boundaries and context	
Start	Kick-off, establish the organisation	Establish the organisation, project planning, PM plan, approval of the PM plan	
Content phases	Rough and detailed concept, implementation, test, training, piloting, launch	Analysis, rough and detailed concept, implementation, training	
Deliverables in initiation	Contract, project assignment, requirements, functional specification, PM plan, risks	Preliminary project assignment	
Deliverables in start	Communication structures, ground rules, change request process	Final project assignment, PM plan, project organisation	

Our project is closer to